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Proposed programme budget for 2027

Programme planning

Proposed programme budget for 2027

Part V

Regional cooperation for development

Section 19

Economic and social development in Asia and the Pacific

Programme 16

Economic and social development in Asia and the Pacific

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* The present document (A/81/6 (Sect. 19)/Part A), consisting of the programme plan and programme performance information (part II; see General Assembly resolution [77/267](#), para. 10), will be replaced by a document containing parts A and B (A/81/6 (Sect. 19)) once part B is issued.

** [A/81/50](#).

*** In keeping with paragraph 10 of General Assembly resolution [77/267](#), the part consisting of the programme plan and programme performance information (part II) is submitted through the Committee for Programme and Coordination for the consideration of the Assembly.



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A. Proposed programme plan for 2027 and programme performance in 2025

Overall orientation

Mandates and background

- 19.1 As the principal intergovernmental platform of the United Nations in the region, the Economic and Social Commission for Asia and the Pacific (ESCAP) supports its member States and associate members in pursuing integrated solutions to advance the sustainable development of the region. Established by Economic and Social Council resolution 37 (IV) and subsequently strengthened through Council resolution 1895 (LVII) to include the social dimension of integrated development, ESCAP derives its mandate from the priorities established in relevant resolutions and decisions of the General Assembly, the Economic and Social Council and the Commission itself.
- 19.2 Guided by the Commission and its sectoral committees, which oversee the work of the secretariat at the regional and subregional levels, ESCAP fulfils its mandate through three interlinked core functions: research and knowledge management; the facilitation of intergovernmental consensus-building and norm-setting; and capacity-development services. These functions enable it to provide policy advice and serve as the regional convener and operational arm of the United Nations for advancing inclusive, resilient and sustainable development across Asia and the Pacific.
- 19.3 The work of ESCAP is further guided by General Assembly resolutions, global development frameworks and the regional road map for implementing the 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development in Asia and the Pacific, endorsed by the Commission in its resolution 73/9, which serve as reference frameworks. The conference structure of the Commission, which was approved through Economic and Social Council resolution 2015/30 and is aligned with the requirements of the 2030 Agenda, is reviewed periodically to ensure its continued relevance. The next review will be presented to the Commission at its eighty-third session, in 2027, for its consideration and decision.

Strategy and external factors for 2027

- 19.4 The programme strategy for 2027 is anchored in the principles and objectives of key global frameworks, such as the 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development, the Pact for the Future and its Global Digital Compact, the Sevilla Commitment of the Fourth International Conference on Financing for Development, the Doha Political Declaration of the “World Social Summit” under the title “the Second World Summit for Social Development” and the programmes of action and development agendas of the least developed countries, landlocked developing countries and small island developing States (countries in special situations). Together, these frameworks underpin the commitment of ESCAP to promoting multilateralism and international cooperation and advancing sustainable, people-centred and inclusive development in the region.
- 19.5 The Commission’s overall programme strategy is aimed at the balanced integration of the economic, social and environmental dimensions to advance sustainable development in Asia and the Pacific. It is implemented through nine subprogrammes, which collectively address the priorities of the region in areas such as macroeconomic policy and financing for development, trade facilitation and infrastructure connectivity, technology and innovation, sustainable management of natural resources and urban development, disaster risk reduction and resilience, social and demographic development and affordable and clean energy, while strengthening member States’ capacities to measure progress towards the achievement of the 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development and their access to timely and quality evidence for informed policymaking. A central focus of the programme of work for 2027 remains on supporting countries in special situations by mainstreaming their needs as well as the relevant global programmes of action and agendas across all areas of work. The implementation of the programme of work is supported by the regular programme of technical cooperation and Development Account projects.

- 19.6 For 2027, the programme of work has been adjusted by strengthening the substantive linkages between the environment and issues related to disaster risk reduction, as reflected in the objective and strategy of subprogrammes 4 and 5 in line with an evaluation recommendation issued by the Office of Internal Oversight Services (OIOS; see also para. 19.21). In consideration of the substantive proximity of environment, climate change and disaster-related issues and aiming to provide more integrated policy advice and effectively deliver on its mandates on environment and development and disaster risk reduction and management, ESCAP has aligned the structure of its programme of work with the thematic grouping of these issues in the United Nations Sustainable Development Cooperation Frameworks of countries in the Asia-Pacific region.
- 19.7 To deliver on its mandates, ESCAP acts as a regional policy platform by convening intergovernmental and multi-stakeholder forums that foster dialogue and build consensus on regional and transboundary challenges. It also fulfils a normative function through the development and implementation of regional action programmes and framework agreements that guide policy alignment and cooperation among member States. Through its research, ESCAP delivers timely analytical work and innovative policy solutions, grounded in its suite of data-driven tools and knowledge repositories. These efforts are complemented by the Commission's operational role, which focuses on providing evidence-based policy advice and demand-driven and context-specific technical assistance, enabling member States to translate regional commitments into tangible national outcomes. By offering capacity development initiatives and peer-to-peer exchanges, ESCAP also aims to strengthen institutional capacities and foster whole-of-government and whole-of-society approaches to accelerate progress towards the achievement of the Sustainable Development Goals.
- 19.8 In 2027, ESCAP will continue to convene the Asia-Pacific Forum on Sustainable Development as the central multi-stakeholder platform for the follow-up and review of the 2030 Agenda in the region. The Forum will provide an opportunity for countries to share experiences, identify regional priorities and develop policy recommendations that contribute to global discussions at the high-level political forum on sustainable development. ESCAP will also assist countries in preparing voluntary national reviews, including through the twinning programme and by enhancing policy coherence, data quality and stakeholder engagement in the process.
- 19.9 With regard to cooperation with other entities at the global, regional, national and local levels, the work of ESCAP will continue to be characterized by strong partnerships and collaboration across a broad and diverse range of stakeholders. The Commission collaborates with global, regional and subregional intergovernmental bodies and international organizations, as well as regional and local government associations, civil society networks and the private sector, in an open and transparent manner to promote durable solutions for regional and transboundary challenges and to advance the priorities of the Asia-Pacific region in global development processes. Building on its long-standing partnerships, ESCAP will pursue joint activities with, inter alia, international development banks and research institutes and will continue to promote North-South, South-South and triangular cooperation as key modalities for implementing its programme of work.
- 19.10 With regard to inter-agency coordination and liaison, ESCAP works in close partnership with the other United Nations regional commissions and contributes to joint global analytical products and to projects implemented under the Development Account. It maintains close collaboration with the Office of the High Representative for the Least Developed Countries, Landlocked Developing Countries and Small Island Developing States to provide coordinated support to the countries in special situations in the region. ESCAP will provide secretariat services to the Regional Collaborative Platform for Asia and the Pacific, supporting issue-based coalitions, including co-leading two of the five issue-based coalitions, namely, the coalition on digital transformation with the International Telecommunication Union and the United Nations Educational, Scientific and Cultural Organization and the coalition on raising ambitions on climate action and energy transition with the United Nations Environment Programme.
- 19.11 Through its subregional offices, ESCAP coordinates with resident coordinators and United Nations country teams, ensuring effective participation in common country assessments and United Nations Sustainable Development Cooperation Frameworks and coherence and complementarity between regional and national actions. It also promotes collaboration across the United Nations system that strengthens the integration of regional outcomes into national sustainable development strategies and reinforces the collective impact of the United Nations development system in the Asia-Pacific region.

- 19.12 With regard to the external factors, the overall plan for 2027 is based on the following planning assumptions:
- (a) National Governments maintain and strengthen their commitment to the Commission as the principal intergovernmental platform in the region for leveraging regional cooperation to meet transboundary and common challenges;
 - (b) Governments and other stakeholders continue to collaborate with the Commission in undertaking the proposed programme activities with the necessary capacity and resources;
 - (c) Extrabudgetary funding for technical cooperation continues to be available, and ESCAP is able to further mobilize voluntary contributions from State and non-State entities.
- 19.13 ESCAP integrates a gender perspective into its operational activities, deliverables and results, as relevant and appropriate. Gender equality and the empowerment of women is a thematic area for subprogramme 6, while advancing the disaggregation of data, including disaggregation by sex, is a focus of subprogramme 7. In the 2027 programme plan, subprogrammes 2, 3, 6 and 7 and component 4 of subprogramme 8 specifically contribute results in this regard, while subprogrammes 2 to 9 mainstream gender equality and the empowerment of women in their respective strategies. In 2027, ESCAP will also continue to implement its gender equality policy and gender equality action plan to accelerate progress in gender equality through concerted actions across its programme of work.
- 19.14 In line with the United Nations Disability Inclusion Strategy, ESCAP is committed to mainstreaming disability perspectives and ensuring the inclusion of persons with disabilities in all its work through its implementation of the ESCAP disability inclusion policy and its action plan. Subprogrammes 3, 5, 6 and 7 and component 4 of subprogramme 8 incorporate disability-specific interventions to support and empower persons with disabilities and, ultimately, to build disability-inclusive societies.

Adjustments arising from the UN80 Initiative

- 19.15 The proposed programme plan for 2027 reflects changes arising from the UN80 Initiative. In particular, the tables of deliverables reflect updated planned deliverables for 2026, in line with the approved programme budget for 2026.
- 19.16 ESCAP will be guided by any future decisions taken in the context of the UN80 Initiative, in accordance with the applicable rules and procedures, including decisions, resolutions and established practice of the competent intergovernmental organs. This includes, among others, any decisions concerning proposals for strengthening collaboration with the United Nations Conference on Trade and Development (UNCTAD), the Department of Economic and Social Affairs of the Secretariat and the other regional commissions through joint mechanisms. ESCAP will jointly explore options for strengthening macroeconomic analysis capacities, with a view to contributing more harmonized analysis and policy support to Member States.

Legislative mandates

- 19.17 The list below, which was reviewed in the preparation of the proposed programme budget, provides all mandates entrusted to the programme.

General Assembly resolutions

61/16	Strengthening of the Economic and Social Council	69/283	Sendai Framework for Disaster Risk Reduction 2015–2030
66/288	The future we want	69/313	Addis Ababa Action Agenda of the Third International Conference on Financing for Development (Addis Ababa Action Agenda)
69/142	Realizing the Millennium Development Goals and other internationally agreed development goals for persons with disabilities towards 2015 and beyond	70/1	Transforming our world: the 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development
69/277	Political declaration on strengthening cooperation between the United Nations and regional and subregional organizations	70/170	Towards the full realization of an inclusive and accessible United Nations for persons with disabilities

Part V	Regional cooperation for development	
72/279	Repositioning of the United Nations development system in the context of the quadrennial comprehensive policy review of operational activities for development of the United Nations system	78/317
74/3	Political declaration of the high-level meeting to review progress made in addressing the priorities of small island developing States through the implementation of the SIDS Accelerated Modalities of Action (SAMOA) Pathway	79/1 79/9 79/149 79/178 79/203
75/290 A	Review of the implementation of General Assembly resolution 72/305 on the strengthening of the Economic and Social Council Review of the implementation of General Assembly resolutions 67/290 on the format and organizational aspects of the high-level political forum on sustainable development and 70/299 on the follow-up and review of the 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development at the global level	79/223 79/226 79/228
75/290 B	High-level political forum on sustainable development	
76/258	Doha Programme of Action for the Least Developed Countries	79/230
76/273	Enhancing accessibility for persons with disabilities to conferences and meetings of the United Nations system	79/233
76/296	Our ocean, our future, our responsibility	79/290
77/21	Cooperation between the United Nations and the Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development (OECD)	79/323 79/332
77/323	Extension of the preparatory period preceding the graduation of Solomon Islands from the least developed country category	79/334
77/332	Cooperation between the United Nations and the Pacific Islands Forum	80/3
78/1	Political declaration of the high-level political forum on sustainable development convened under the auspices of the General Assembly	80/110 80/127
78/147	Central Asia facing environmental challenges: fostering regional solidarity for sustainable development and prosperity	80/129
78/259	International Day of Science, Technology and Innovation for the South	80/133
78/265	Seizing the opportunities of safe, secure and trustworthy artificial intelligence systems for sustainable development	80/135
78/285	Review of the implementation of General Assembly resolution 75/290 A on the strengthening of the Economic and Social Council and resolution 75/290 B on the high-level political forum on sustainable development and the follow-up and review of the 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development at the global level	80/136 80/143 80/147
78/311	Enhancing international cooperation on capacity-building of artificial intelligence	80/149
		The Antigua and Barbuda Agenda for Small Island Developing States: A Renewed Declaration for Resilient Prosperity The Pact for the Future Cooperation between the United Nations and the Organization of Islamic Cooperation Inclusive development for and with persons with disabilities Human rights and extreme poverty Follow-up to and implementation of the SIDS Accelerated Modalities of Action (SAMOA) Pathway and the Mauritius Strategy for the Further Implementation of the Programme of Action for the Sustainable Development of Small Island Developing States Women in development Quadrennial comprehensive policy review of operational activities for development of the United Nations system Towards global partnerships: a principle-based approach to enhanced cooperation between the United Nations and all relevant partners Graduation of Cambodia and Senegal from the least developed country category Programme of Action for Landlocked Developing Countries for the Decade 2024–2034 Cooperation between the United Nations and the Association of Southeast Asian Nations Sevilla Commitment Cooperation between the United Nations and the Shanghai Cooperation Organization Impact of rapid technological change on the achievement of the Sustainable Development Goals and targets Awaza Political Declaration Oceans and the law of the sea Promoting investments for sustainable development Follow-up to and implementation of the outcomes of the International Conferences on Financing for Development Agricultural technology for sustainable development Promoting sustainable consumption and production patterns for the implementation of the 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development, building on Agenda 21 Follow-up to and implementation of the Antigua and Barbuda Agenda for Small Island Developing States: A Renewed Declaration for Resilient Prosperity Combating sand and dust storms Science, technology and innovation for sustainable development Development cooperation with middle-income countries

Section 19 Economic and social development in Asia and the Pacific

80/150	Follow-up to the Fifth United Nations Conference on the Least Developed Countries	80/156	South-South cooperation
80/151	Follow-up to the Third United Nations Conference on Landlocked Developing Countries	80/157	Agriculture development, food security and nutrition
80/153	Implementation of the Third United Nations Decade for the Eradication of Poverty (2018–2027)	80/181	Promoting social integration through social inclusion
80/154	Eradicating rural poverty to implement the 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development	80/191	Rights of Indigenous Peoples
80/155	Operational activities for development of the United Nations system	80/197	Implementation of the Convention on the Rights of Persons with Disabilities and the Optional Protocol thereto: amplified barriers in diverse contexts
		80/207	The right to development

Economic and Social Council resolutions

37 (IV)	Economic Commission for Asia and the Far East	2022/11	A conference structure of the Economic and Social Commission for Asia and the Pacific to advance sustainable development
1895 (LVII)	Change of name of the “Economic Commission for Asia and the Far East” to “Economic and Social Commission for Asia and the Pacific”	2023/14	Creating full and productive employment and decent work for all as a way of overcoming inequalities to accelerate the recovery from the COVID-19 pandemic and the full implementation of the 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development
1998/46	Further measures for the restructuring and revitalization of the United Nations in the economic, social and related fields		
2015/30	Restructuring the conference structure of the Economic and Social Commission for Asia and the Pacific to be fit for the evolving post-2015 development agenda	2023/31; 2024/19	Progress in the implementation of General Assembly resolution 75/233 on the quadrennial comprehensive policy review of operational activities for development of the United Nations system
2016/11	Committing to the effective implementation of the 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development in Asia and the Pacific	2025/2	Report of the Committee for Development Policy on its twenty-seventh session
2018/5	Strategies for eradicating poverty to achieve sustainable development for all	2025/4	Mainstreaming a gender perspective into all policies and programmes in the United Nations system
2020/5	Strengthening coordination of the statistical programmes in the United Nations system	2025/23	Doha Programme of Action for the Least Developed Countries for the decade 2022–2031
2021/10	Socially just transition towards sustainable development: the role of digital technologies on social development and well-being of all	2025/32	Support to Non-Self-Governing Territories by the specialized agencies and international institutions associated with the United Nations

Economic and Social Commission for Asia and the Pacific resolutions

66/1	Incheon Declaration	72/9	Regional cooperation to promote the conservation and sustainable use of the oceans, seas and marine resources for sustainable development in Asia and the Pacific
66/9	Full and effective implementation of the Beijing Platform for Action and its regional and global outcomes in the Asia-Pacific region		
66/15	Strengthening of the evaluation function of the secretariat of the Commission	73/3	Advancing integrated and seamless connectivity for sustainable development in Asia and the Pacific
67/14	Cooperation between the Economic and Social Commission for Asia and the Pacific and other United Nations and regional and subregional organizations serving Asia and the Pacific	73/5	Strengthening Asia-Pacific’s support for the United Nations Conference to Support the Implementation of Sustainable Development Goal 14
71/4	Implementation of the SIDS Accelerated Modalities of Action (SAMOA) Pathway	73/9	Regional road map for implementing the 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development in Asia and the Pacific
72/8	Fostering regional cooperation and partnerships to respond to the climate change challenge in the Asia-Pacific region	74/1	Supporting the smooth transition of the least developed countries in Asia and the Pacific towards a sustainable graduation

Part V	Regional cooperation for development		
74/6	Advancing disaster-related statistics in Asia and the Pacific	78/1	Bangkok Declaration Commemorating the Seventy-fifth Anniversary of the Economic and Social Commission for Asia and the Pacific: A Common Agenda to Advance Sustainable Development in Asia and the Pacific
75/3	Advancing partnerships within and across regions for the sustainable development of Asia and the Pacific		
75/4	Strengthening regional cooperation to tackle air pollution challenges in Asia and the Pacific	79/1	Accelerating climate action in Asia and the Pacific for sustainable development
75/9	Implementation of the Declaration on Navigating Policy with Data to Leave No One Behind	79/3	Supporting the sustainable development of least developed countries, landlocked developing countries and small island developing States in Asia and the Pacific
76/1	Strengthening cooperation to promote the conservation and sustainable use of the oceans, seas and marine resources for sustainable development in Asia and the Pacific	79/4	Accelerating the implementation of the 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development for a better future for all in Asia and the Pacific
76/2	Regional cooperation to address the socioeconomic effects of pandemics and crises in Asia and the Pacific	80/2	Sustainable development in least developed countries, landlocked developing countries and small island developing States
77/1	Building back better from crises through regional cooperation in Asia and the Pacific	81/1	Advancing the sustainable development of middle-income countries in Asia and the Pacific
		81/2	Regional cooperation for resilient and sustainable urban development in Asia and the Pacific

Subprogramme 1

Macroeconomic policy, poverty reduction and financing for development

General Assembly resolutions

78/322	Multidimensional vulnerability index	80/123	External debt sustainability and development
80/122	International financial system and development		

Economic and Social Commission for Asia and the Pacific resolutions

E/CN.11/63	Statistical and economic documentation work	71/5	Implementing the outcome of the Asia-Pacific High-level Consultation on Financing for Development
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Subprogramme 2

Trade, investment and innovation

General Assembly resolutions

79/201	Entrepreneurship for sustainable development	80/121	International trade and development
79/213	Promoting the social and solidarity economy for sustainable development		

Economic and Social Commission for Asia and the Pacific resolutions

68/3	Enabling paperless trade and the cross-border recognition of electronic data and documents for inclusive and sustainable intraregional trade facilitation	72/4	Framework Agreement on Facilitation of Cross-border Paperless Trade in Asia and the Pacific
70/5	Strengthening regional cooperation and capacity for enhanced trade and investment in support of sustainable development	72/12	Harnessing science, technology and innovation for inclusive and sustainable development in Asia and the Pacific
72/3	Statute of the Asian and Pacific Centre for Transfer of Technology	75/8	Advancing science, technology and innovation for the implementation of the 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development in Asia and the Pacific

Subprogramme 3 Transport

General Assembly resolutions

69/213	Role of transport and transit corridors in ensuring international cooperation for sustainable development	77/286 78/148	World Sustainable Transport Day Strengthening the links between all modes of transport to achieve the Sustainable Development Goals
70/197	Towards comprehensive cooperation among all modes of transport for promoting sustainable multimodal transit corridors	78/290 80/132	Improving global road safety United Nations Decade of Sustainable Transport 2026–2035
76/294	Political declaration of the high-level meeting on improving global road safety		

Economic and Social Commission for Asia and the Pacific resolutions

70/7	Implementation of the Suva Declaration on Improving Maritime Transport and Related Services in the Pacific	72/5	Strengthening regional cooperation on transport connectivity for sustainable development in Asia and the Pacific
71/6	Maritime transport connectivity for sustainable development	74/2	Promotion of the regional framework for the planning, design, development and operation of dry ports of international importance
71/7	Adoption of the Regional Cooperation Framework for the Facilitation of International Railway Transport	74/3	Improving road safety in Asia and the Pacific for sustainable transport systems
71/8	Strengthening intraregional and interregional connectivity in Asia and the Pacific	78/3	Implementation of the Ministerial Declaration on Sustainable Transport Development in Asia and the Pacific

Subprogramme 4 Environment and development and disaster risk reduction and management

General Assembly resolutions

71/222	International Decade for Action, “Water for Sustainable Development”, 2018–2028	78/327	Modalities of the 2026 United Nations Water Conference to Accelerate the Implementation of Sustainable Development Goal 6: Ensure availability and sustainable management of water and sanitation for all
71/256	New Urban Agenda		
74/212	International Day of Clean Air for blue skies		
77/289	Political declaration of the high-level meeting on the midterm review of the Sendai Framework for Disaster Risk Reduction 2015–2030	79/210 79/314 80/113	Harmony with Nature Our ocean, our future: united for urgent action International cooperation on humanitarian assistance in the field of natural disasters, from relief to development
77/334	Follow-up to the United Nations Conference on the Midterm Comprehensive Review of the Implementation of the Objectives of the International Decade for Action, “Water for Sustainable Development”, 2018–2028	80/137 80/140	Disaster risk reduction Implementation of the Convention on Biological Diversity and its contribution to sustainable development
78/314	United Nations Decade on Combating Sand and Dust Storms (2025–2034)		

Economic and Social Council resolution

2015/14	Strengthening of the coordination of emergency humanitarian assistance of the United Nations	2015/31 2017/24	Establishment of the Asian and Pacific Centre for the Development of Disaster Information Management Human settlements
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Economic and Social Commission for Asia and the Pacific resolutions and decisions

70/12	Strengthening efforts on human settlements and sustainable urban development for the Asia-Pacific region	71/9	Strengthening cooperation on sustainable management of water resources in Asia and the Pacific
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Part V	Regional cooperation for development		
71/12	Strengthening regional mechanisms for the implementation of the Sendai Framework for Disaster Risk Reduction 2015–2030 in Asia and the Pacific	75/5	Implementation of the Ulaanbaatar Declaration of the 2018 Asian Ministerial Conference on Disaster Risk Reduction
72/2	Statute of the Centre for Sustainable Agricultural Mechanization	Decision 78/6	Report of the Governing Council of the Asian and Pacific Centre for the Development of Disaster Information Management
72/7	Regional cooperation to combat sand and dust storms in Asia and the Pacific	79/6	Implementation of the Ministerial Declaration on Protecting Our Planet through Regional Cooperation and Solidarity in Asia and the Pacific
72/11	Advancing disaster-related statistics in Asia and the Pacific for implementation of internationally agreed development goals	79/7	Advancing regional cooperation for sustainable urban development and localization of the Sustainable Development Goals in Asia and the Pacific
73/7	Enhancing regional cooperation for the implementation of the Sendai Framework for Disaster Risk Reduction 2015–2030 in Asia and the Pacific	81/3	Strengthening cooperation on the water and climate change nexus for sustainable development in Asia and the Pacific
74/4	Implementation of the Ministerial Declaration on Environment and Development for Asia and the Pacific, 2017		

Subprogramme 5 **Information and communications technology and space applications**

General Assembly resolutions

79/322	Role of artificial intelligence in creating new opportunities for sustainable development in Central Asia	80/118	Information and communications technologies for sustainable development
80/76	International cooperation in the peaceful uses of outer space	80/173	Outcome document of the high-level meeting of the General Assembly on the overall review of the implementation of the outcomes of the World Summit on the Information Society

Economic and Social Council resolutions

2016/27	Strengthening institutional arrangements on geospatial information management	2025/18	Assessment of the progress made in the implementation of and follow-up to the outcomes of the World Summit on the Information Society
2018/14	Strategic Framework on Geospatial Information and Services for Disasters		

Economic and Social Commission for Asia and the Pacific resolutions

61/6	Establishment of the Asian and Pacific Training Centre for Information and Communication Technology for Development	79/9	Implementation of the Jakarta Ministerial Declaration on Space Applications for Sustainable Development in Asia and the Pacific
72/10	Regional review of the implementation of the World Summit on the Information Society action lines	79/10	Promoting digital cooperation and inclusion through the Action Plan for Implementing the Asia-Pacific Information Superhighway Initiative, 2022–2026
75/6	Implementation of the Ministerial Declaration on Space Applications for Sustainable Development in Asia and the Pacific and the Asia-Pacific Plan of Action on Space Applications for Sustainable Development (2018–2030)	80/1	Leveraging digital innovation for sustainable development in Asia and the Pacific
75/7	Advancing the implementation of the Asia-Pacific Information Superhighway initiative through regional cooperation	81/4	Astana Ministerial Declaration on Digital Inclusion and Transformation in Asia and the Pacific

Subprogramme 6 **Social development**

General Assembly resolutions

49/128	Report of the International Conference on Population and Development	65/234	Follow-up to the International Conference on Population and Development beyond 2014
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Section 19 Economic and social development in Asia and the Pacific

65/312	Outcome document of the High-level Meeting of the General Assembly on Youth: Dialogue and Mutual Understanding	79/217 80/5	International migration and development Doha Political Declaration of the “World Social Summit” under the title “the Second World Summit for Social Development”
68/4	Declaration of the High-level Dialogue on International Migration and Development	80/152	Contribution of the care economy to sustainable development
73/195	Global Compact for Safe, Orderly and Regular Migration	80/178	Implementation of the outcome of the World Summit for Social Development and of the twenty-fourth special session of the General Assembly
73/326	Format and organizational aspects of the international migration review forums		
75/131	United Nations Decade of Healthy Ageing (2021–2030)	80/179	Follow-up to the Second World Assembly on Ageing
76/266	Progress Declaration of the International Migration Review Forum	80/180	Policies and programmes involving youth
77/193	Intensification of efforts to prevent and eliminate all forms of violence against women and girls: gender stereotypes and negative social norms	80/183 80/184	Follow-up to the thirtieth anniversary of the International Year of the Family and beyond Improvement of the situation of women and girls in rural areas
78/324	Consideration of decision 14/1 of the Open-ended Working Group on Ageing, entitled “Recommendations regarding the identification of possible gaps in the protection of the human rights of older persons and how best to address them”	80/186	Follow-up to the Fourth World Conference on Women and full implementation of the Beijing Declaration and Platform for Action and the outcome of the twenty-third special session of the General Assembly
79/152	Intensification of efforts to prevent and eliminate all forms of violence against women and girls: the digital environment	80/199	Effective promotion of the Declaration on the Rights of Persons Belonging to National or Ethnic, Religious and Linguistic Minorities

Economic and Social Council resolutions

2016/25	Future organization and methods of work of the Commission on Population and Development	2024/6	Fostering social development and social justice through social policies to accelerate progress on the implementation of the 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development and to achieve the overarching goal of poverty eradication
2017/12	Promoting the rights of persons with disabilities and strengthening the mainstreaming of disability in the implementation of the 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development	2025/5	Future organization and methods of work of the Commission for Social Development
2022/4	Future organization and methods of work of the Commission on the Status of Women	2025/7	Strengthening solidarity, social inclusion and social cohesion to accelerate the delivery of the commitments of the Copenhagen Declaration on Social Development and Programme of Action of the World Summit for Social Development as well as the implementation of the 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development
2023/15	Fourth review and appraisal of the Madrid International Plan of Action on Ageing, 2002		
2024/4	Promoting care and support systems for social development	2025/8	Modalities for the fifth review and appraisal of the Madrid International Plan of Action on Ageing, 2002
		2026/2	Revitalization of the Commission on the Status of Women

Economic and Social Commission for Asia and the Pacific resolutions and decisions

74 (XXIII)	Regional co-operation in the field of population	70/14	Enhancing participation of youth in sustainable development in Asia and the Pacific
67/6	Enhancing accessibility for persons with disabilities at ESCAP	Decision 70/22	Report of the Sixth Asian and Pacific Population Conference
69/14	Implementation of the Bangkok statement on the Asia-Pacific review of the implementation of the Madrid International Plan of Action on Ageing	71/13	Implementation of the Asian and Pacific Ministerial Declaration on Advancing Gender Equality and Women’s Empowerment

Part V Regional cooperation for development

74/11	Strengthening regional cooperation to tackle inequality in all its forms in Asia and the Pacific	79/5	Implementation of the Jakarta Declaration on the Asian and Pacific Decade of Persons with Disabilities, 2023–2032
Decision 75/7	Report of the Midterm Review of the Asia and Pacific Ministerial Declaration on Population and Development including the Chair's summary	Decision 79/6	Asia-Pacific Intergovernmental Meeting on the Fourth Review and Appraisal of the Madrid International Plan of Action on Ageing
Decision 76/8	Asia-Pacific indicator framework for monitoring progress towards the implementation of the Programme of Action of the International Conference on Population and Development and of the commitments contained in the Asian and Pacific Ministerial Declaration on Population and Development	Decision 80/5	Reports of intergovernmental bodies and meeting held since the seventy-ninth session
		Decision 80/6	Working Group on the Asian and Pacific Decade of Persons with Disabilities, 2023–2032
		Decision 81/8	Asia-Pacific Ministerial Conference on the Beijing+30 Review
Decision 77/6	Report of the Asia-Pacific Regional Review of Implementation of the Global Compact for Safe, Orderly and Regular Migration	Decision 81/9	Second Asia-Pacific Regional Review of Implementation of the Global Compact for Safe, Orderly and Regular Migration

Subprogramme 7 Statistics

General Assembly resolutions

68/261	Fundamental Principles of Official Statistics	71/313	Work of the Statistical Commission pertaining to the 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development
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Economic and Social Council resolutions

2006/6	Strengthening statistical capacity	2022/3	Ensuring that the work in the field of statistics and data is adaptive to the changing statistical and data ecosystem
2011/15	Revision of the statute of the Statistical Institute for Asia and the Pacific		
2013/21	Fundamental Principles of Official Statistics	2025/12	System of National Accounts 2025
2017/7	Work of the Statistical Commission pertaining to the 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development		

Economic and Social Commission for Asia and the Pacific resolutions

246 (XLII)	Statistical services in Asia and the Pacific	69/16	A core set of population and social statistics to guide national capacity development in Asia and the Pacific
65/2	Regional technical cooperation and capacity-building in statistics development in Asia and the Pacific	71/14	Asian and Pacific Civil Registration and Vital Statistics Decade, 2015–2024
67/10	A core set of economic statistics to guide the improvement of basic economic statistics in Asia and the Pacific	74/8	Accelerating the implementation of the Regional Action Framework on Civil Registration and Vital Statistics in Asia and the Pacific
67/11	Strengthening statistical capacity in Asia and the Pacific		
67/12	Improvement of civil registration and vital statistics in Asia and the Pacific	78/4	Implementation of the Ministerial Declaration on Building a More Resilient Future with Inclusive Civil Registration and Vital Statistics
69/15	Implementing the outcome of the High-level Meeting on the Improvement of Civil Registration and Vital Statistics in Asia and the Pacific		

Subprogramme 8 Subregional activities for development

General Assembly resolutions

63/260	Development-related activities	78/9	Commemoration of the twenty-fifth anniversary of the United Nations Special Programme for the Economies of Central Asia
72/283	Strengthening regional and international cooperation to ensure peace, stability and sustainable development in the Central Asian region	79/268	United Nations Regional Centre for Sustainable Development Goals for Central Asia and Afghanistan

Economic and Social Commission for Asia and the Pacific resolution

244 (XLI)	The Commission's Activities in the Pacific
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Subprogramme 9 Energy

General Assembly resolutions

77/327	International Day of Clean Energy	80/142	Ensuring access to affordable, reliable, sustainable and modern energy for all
80/131	The pivotal role of reliable and stable energy connectivity in driving sustainable development		

Economic and Social Council resolutions

2011/14	Promoting regional cooperation for enhanced energy security and the sustainable use of energy in Asia and the Pacific	2023/19	United Nations Resource Management System Principles and Requirements
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Economic and Social Commission for Asia and the Pacific resolutions

64/3	Promoting renewables for energy security and sustainable development in Asia and the Pacific	73/8	Strengthening regional cooperation for sustainable energy development in Asia and the Pacific
70/9; 74/9	Implementation of the outcomes of the Asian and Pacific Energy Forum	80/3	Ministerial Declaration on Building a Secure, Sustainable and Interconnected Energy Future for Asia and the Pacific

Deliverables

19.18 Table 19.1 lists all cross-cutting deliverables of the programme.

Table 19.1

Cross-cutting deliverables for the period 2025–2027, by category and subcategory

Category and subcategory	2025 planned	2025 actual	2026 planned	2027 planned
A. Facilitation of the intergovernmental process and expert bodies				
Parliamentary documentation (number of documents)	9	8	9	11
Reports for:				
1. The Commission	3	4	4	6
2. The Asia-Pacific Forum on Sustainable Development	6	4	5	5
Substantive services for meetings (number of three-hour meetings)	36	32	36	36
Meetings of:				
3. The Commission	10	9	10	10
4. The Asia-Pacific Forum on Sustainable Development	8	7	8	8

Category and subcategory	2025 planned	2025 actual	2026 planned	2027 planned
5. The Advisory Committee of Permanent Representatives and Other Representatives Designated by Members of the Commission	6	6	6	6
6. The expert groups on least developed countries, landlocked developing countries and small island developing States	3	1	3	3
7. The Committee for Programme and Coordination	1	1	1	1
8. The Advisory Committee on Administrative and Budgetary Questions	2	2	2	2
9. The Fifth Committee	2	2	2	2
10. The Regional Collaborative Platform for Asia and the Pacific	4	4	4	4
B. Generation and transfer of knowledge				
Field and technical cooperation projects (number of projects)	2	1	1	1
11. On selected issues pertinent to the sustainable development of least developed countries, landlocked developing countries and small island developing States	2	1	1	1
Seminars, workshops and training events (number of days)	2	–	2	2
12. Subregional workshops on priorities of the programmes of action for least developed countries, landlocked developing countries and small island developing States	1	–	1	1
13. Policy dialogues based on the <i>Asia-Pacific Countries with Special Needs Development Report</i>	1	–	1	1
Publications (number of publications)	5	5	5	5
14. ESCAP theme study	1	1	1	1
15. <i>Asia-Pacific Countries with Special Needs Development Report</i>	1	1	1	1
16. On the implementation of the 2030 Agenda	1	1	1	1
17. <i>Asia-Pacific Sustainable Development Journal</i>	2	2	2	2
Technical materials (number of materials)	4	3	4	4
18. On issues relevant to Asia-Pacific countries in special situations	4	3	4	4
C. Substantive deliverables				
Databases and substantive digital materials: Asia-Pacific Sustainable Development Goal partnership data portal containing more than 1,000 data sets on the Sustainable Development Goals.				
D. Communication deliverables				
Outreach programmes, special events and information materials: outreach programmes upon demand for the public, including for academic organizations, for approximately 300 participants.				
External and media relations: press releases and op-ed articles on the work and activities of ESCAP; newsletter on subregional activities for development; press conferences/press briefings and press interviews for publications and events.				
Digital platforms and multimedia content: multimedia promotional content, including videos and educational materials for major publications and events; content for ESCAP social media accounts.				

Evaluation activities

- 19.19 The following evaluations conducted by ESCAP and completed in 2025 have guided the proposed programme plan for 2027:
- (a) Evaluation of the Statistical Institute for Asia and the Pacific;
 - (b) Evaluation of the Centre for Sustainable Agricultural Mechanization;
 - (c) Evaluation of the Asian and Pacific Centre for the Development of Disaster Information Management.
- 19.20 In response to the findings of the ESCAP evaluations referenced above, the Statistical Institute for Asia and the Pacific enhanced its collaboration with national statistical training institutes across the Asia-Pacific region to promote South-South cooperation. It also refined its approach to better target specific subregions and countries with special needs. The Centre for Sustainable Agricultural Mechanization

advanced its work on sustainable agricultural mechanization and practices, focusing particularly on reducing crop burning through integrated straw management, and initiated new pilot sites in the Lao People's Democratic Republic and Thailand. The Asian and Pacific Centre for the Development of Disaster Information Management deepened its collaboration with the other subprogrammes and regional institutions to enhance results orientation, impact and resource efficiency.

- 19.21 In addition, in response to an OIOS evaluation of subprogramme 4, Environment and development (as it was previously named), completed in 2022, ESCAP integrated the Disaster Risk Reduction Section of the Information and Communications Technology and Disaster Risk Reduction Division within the Environment and Development Division in consideration of the substantive proximity of environment, climate change and disaster-related issues.
- 19.22 An internal evaluation of the ESCAP approach to leveraging artificial intelligence to support member States is planned for 2027.

Programme of work

Subprogramme 1

Macroeconomic policy, poverty reduction and financing for development

Objective

- 19.23 The objective, to which this subprogramme contributes, is to strengthen the capacity of member States to achieve stable, inclusive and sustainable economic development in Asia and the Pacific.

Strategy

- 19.24 To contribute to the objective, the subprogramme will support member States, especially countries in special situations and countries facing specific challenges, in transforming their economies in a manner that is consistent with the 2030 Agenda, contributing to the achievement of Sustainable Development Goals 1, 8 to 10, 13 and 17, and promote an inclusive and resilient development approach that goes beyond the primary focus on economic growth. Specifically, the subprogramme will:
- (a) Support member States in exploring, adopting and mainstreaming economic development policies and financing strategies aligned with the achievement of the Goals, through methodologies developed through and policy recommendations emerging from knowledge products, technical advisory and capacity-building efforts and the facilitation of knowledge exchange and consensus-building among member States;
 - (b) Undertake research, advisory and capacity-building services on country-level policymaking and regional-level sharing of policy experiences, guided by the Committee on Macroeconomic Policy, Poverty Reduction and Financing for Development of the Commission and further supported through the Consultative Group on Financing Strategies for the Sustainable Development Goals;
 - (c) Undertake outreach and follow-up of the subprogramme's research and knowledge products through policy dialogues and closer cooperation of members of the Consultative Group, policy think tanks, resident coordinator offices and United Nations country teams to further integrate the subprogramme's research and capacity-building work;
 - (d) Provide substantive inputs to global and United Nations system-wide processes and initiatives, in particular on financing for development issues, and to task teams and publications coordinated by the Department of Economic and Social Affairs of the Secretariat.

- 19.25 The above-mentioned work is expected to result in:
- (a) Evidence-based economic policies and development strategies for strengthened economic resilience, inclusive development, poverty reduction and environmental sustainability;
 - (b) The strengthened ability of member States, in particular least developed countries, to mobilize and allocate financial resources for sustainable development, including by mainstreaming sustainable development into public and private financing;
 - (c) The enhanced capacity of member States to promote the transformation of their economies towards resilient, inclusive and sustainable development pathways.

Programme performance in 2025

Asia-Pacific countries' priorities reflected in the global financing for development agenda

- 19.26 The Fourth International Conference on Financing for Development, held in 2025, marked a critical milestone in advancing the global financing agenda through the adoption of the Sevilla Commitment. In preparation for the Conference, the subprogramme supported Asia-Pacific member States to channel regional perspectives into the process. This included organizing a high-level regional consultation on financing for development in Asia and the Pacific in December 2024, in collaboration with UNCTAD, the Asian Development Bank (ADB) and the Asian Infrastructure Investment Bank, which gathered 32 Governments, 27 international organizations, including United Nations entities, 29 civil society organizations and private sector representatives to shape common priorities.
- 19.27 To inform the regional consultation, the subprogramme prepared an issues paper entitled *Strengthening Financing for Sustainable Development in Asia and the Pacific: a Discussion of Selected Policy Areas*, which set out key regional challenges and policy options. The main messages of the regional consultation were summarized in the Chair's summary and were shared with the co-facilitators of the Fourth International Conference on Financing for Development as perspectives from Asia and the Pacific. The subprogramme actively participated in the Conference, delivering statements in the plenary and the multi-stakeholder round tables to highlight Asia-Pacific priorities. It organized several side events with partners on select aspects of the implementation of the Sevilla Commitment, one jointly organized by all regional commissions. Many of the main messages were included in the Sevilla Commitment, which encourages enhanced regional follow-up processes, as part of the regional forums on sustainable development led by the regional economic commissions, with regular regional reporting on progress, regional committees and consultations on progress and priorities.
- 19.28 Progress towards the objective is presented in the performance measure below (see table 19.2).

Table 19.2
Performance measure

2023 (actual)	2024 (actual)	2025 (actual)
—	—	Asia-Pacific priorities on financing for development were reflected in the Sevilla Commitment, and the role of regional commissions in leading follow-up processes was affirmed in the outcome of Member State negotiations

Planned results for 2027

Result 1: improved policymaking for macroeconomic and financing for development issues

Programme performance in 2025 and target for 2027

- 19.29 The subprogramme's work contributed to 91 per cent of policymakers surveyed acknowledging strengthened policy awareness on emerging macroeconomic and financing for development issues and 82 per cent confirming the intention to apply newly acquired policy ideas in actual policymaking and implementation, which exceeded the planned target of at least 65 per cent of policymakers engaged acknowledging strengthened policy awareness on emerging macroeconomic and financing for development issues.
- 19.30 Progress towards the objective and the target for 2027 are presented in the performance measure below (see table 19.3).

Table 19.3

Performance measure

<i>2023 (actual)</i>	<i>2024 (actual)</i>	<i>2025 (actual)</i>	<i>2026 (planned)</i>	<i>2027 (planned)</i>
Policymakers engaged in interactive discussions with experts through policy dialogues on flagship publications	86 per cent of policymakers surveyed acknowledged strengthened policy awareness on emerging macroeconomic and financing for development issues	91 per cent of policymakers surveyed acknowledged strengthened policy awareness on emerging macroeconomic and financing for development issues	At least 75 per cent of policymakers engaged acknowledge strengthened policy awareness on emerging macroeconomic and financing for development issues	At least 75 per cent of policymakers engaged acknowledge strengthened policy awareness on emerging macroeconomic, poverty reduction and financing for development issues
	68 per cent acknowledged the intention to apply newly acquired policy ideas in actual policymaking and implementation	82 per cent acknowledged the intention to apply newly acquired policy ideas in actual policymaking and implementation		

Result 2: member States introduce new policy initiatives and reforms to accelerate financing for sustainable development

Programme performance in 2025 and target for 2027

- 19.31 The subprogramme's work contributed to new initiatives and reforms by Cambodia, Mongolia and Tajikistan (all are countries in special situations), which met the planned target of new initiatives or reforms by three member States to strengthen financing for sustainable development.
- 19.32 Progress towards the objective and the target for 2027 are presented in the performance measure below (see table 19.4).

Table 19.4
Performance measure

2023 (actual)	2024 (actual)	2025 (actual)	2026 (planned)	2027 (planned)
Bhutan, Cambodia and Sri Lanka initiated policy changes to strengthen financing for sustainable development	Bhutan developed its Sustainability Bond Framework Cambodia issued new green bonds and began drafting a national sustainable finance road map and creating a sustainable finance task force Sri Lanka undertook a validation of its Green Bond Framework	Cambodia issued its second green bond and integrated the Sustainable Bond Accelerator into its third-generation nationally determined contribution with explicit bond issuance targets Mongolia issued disclosure guidelines for financial institutions on integrating risks related to climate change, with a timeline for mandatory reporting Tajikistan began drafting a national sustainable finance road map	New initiatives or reforms by three member States that support the acceleration of financing for sustainable development	New initiatives or reforms by three member States that support the acceleration of financing for sustainable development

Result 3: member States design, assess or deploy macroeconomic policies to accelerate progress for climate-resilient development

Proposed programme plan for 2027

- 19.33 A transition to low-emission and climate-resilient economies has wide-ranging implications on macroeconomic resilience and development, while its success also relies on prudent and forward-looking macroeconomic policy choices that balance and find synergies across economic, social and environmental objectives. Supporting policy alignment between macroeconomic policy considerations and transformation strategies that enable sustainability and poverty reduction are thus a central component of the subprogramme's work. The subprogramme has studied extensively the linkages between sustainable transformation and macroeconomic development and has been exploring economically viable paths of achieving such transitions.

Lessons learned and planned change

- 19.34 The lesson for the subprogramme was that operational guidelines and policy analysis tools, as well as a knowledge repository of practical policy options that have been tested in some countries, are essential for turning quality policy research into actual policy changes. In applying the lesson, the subprogramme will develop such guidelines and tools, together with a repository of tested policy options, to support efforts by member States towards better alignment of macroeconomic policies with transformation needs for sustainability and poverty reduction.
- 19.35 Expected progress towards the objective is presented in the performance measure below (see table 19.5).

Table 19.5
Performance measure

2023 (actual)	2024 (actual)	2025 (actual)	2026 (planned)	2027 (planned)
—	—	Member States have access to in-depth research on macroeconomic implications of climate change	Member States have access to in-depth research on interlinkages between macroeconomic development and just and inclusive energy transitions	70 per cent of policymakers participating in ESCAP-organized workshops acquire new knowledge on macroeconomic policymaking and sustainable transformation and at least one country starts designing or assessing needed policies with support from the subprogramme

Deliverables

19.36 Table 19.6 lists all deliverables of the subprogramme.

Table 19.6
Subprogramme 1: deliverables for the period 2025–2027, by category and subcategory

Category and subcategory	2025 planned	2025 actual	2026 planned ^a	2027 planned
A. Facilitation of the intergovernmental process and expert bodies				
Parliamentary documentation (number of documents)	4	7	2	4
Reports for:				
1. The Commission	1	2	2	1
2. The Committee on Macroeconomic Policy, Poverty Reduction and Financing for Development	3	5	—	3
Substantive services for meetings (number of three-hour meetings)	13	11	7	10
Meetings of:				
3. The Committee on Macroeconomic Policy, Poverty Reduction and Financing for Development	6	5	—	5
4. Subregional policy round table on issues related to financing for sustainable development	1	—	1	1
5. Expert groups on financing for development	—	—	2 [4]	—
6. Expert groups on the <i>Economic and Social Survey of Asia and the Pacific</i>	4	4	2 [4]	2
7. The Consultative Group on Financing Strategies for the Sustainable Development Goals	2	2	2	2
B. Generation and transfer of knowledge				
Field and technical cooperation projects (number of projects)	1	4	1	1
8. On selected economic policy and financing for development issues	1	4	1	1
Seminars, workshops and training events (number of days)	4	3	4	3
9. Policy-focused discussions based on research outlined in the <i>Economic and Social Survey of Asia and the Pacific</i> and <i>Financing for Development in Asia and the Pacific</i>	4	3	4	3

Category and subcategory	2025 planned	2025 actual	2026 planned ^a	2027 planned
Publications (number of publications)	2	2	1	2
10. <i>Economic and Social Survey of Asia and the Pacific</i>	1	1	1	1
11. <i>Financing for Development Series</i>	1	1	–	1
Technical materials (number of materials)	10	21	11	11
12. Knowledge products on economic issues and policies tailored to countries' specific circumstances	4	12	4	4
13. Working paper series on macroeconomic policy, poverty reduction and financing for development	2	4	1 [2]	1
14. Policy briefs on macroeconomic policy, poverty reduction and financing for development	4	5	2 [4]	2
15. Economic update for the Asia-Pacific region	–	–	4	4

C. Substantive deliverables

Consultation, advice and advocacy: advocacy event on financing for development at the Economic and Social Council; side events at the Asia-Pacific Forum on Sustainable Development.

D. Communication deliverables

Outreach programmes, special events and information materials: presentations and brochures on the *Economic and Social Survey of Asia and the Pacific* and the *Financing for Development Series*.

^a Reflects updated planned deliverables for 2026. Values in square brackets represent the number of planned deliverables reflected in A/80/6 (Sect. 19).

Subprogramme 2 Trade, investment and innovation

Objective

- 19.37 The objective, to which this subprogramme contributes, is to strengthen the capacity of member States to implement policies and programmes that more effectively harness the potential of trade, investment, innovation, technology and enterprise development for inclusive and sustainable development and regional integration in Asia and the Pacific.

Strategy

- 19.38 To contribute to the objective, the subprogramme will:
- (a) Support member States in formulating and implementing policies and measures to promote and facilitate trade, investment, innovation and enterprise development in support of inclusive and sustainable development, with a specific focus on the needs of countries in special situations, including countries on the cusp of graduation from least developed country status, and with a view to mitigating increased supply chain disruptions;
 - (b) Build the capacity of member States, in cooperation with global and regional partners, such as ADB, UNCTAD and the World Trade Organization, to negotiate and implement trade agreements aligned with the 2030 Agenda and to design and implement trade and investment facilitation policies and measures, including through the adoption of paperless trade systems;
 - (c) Provide capacity-building with the Asian and Pacific Centre for Transfer of Technology, including capacity-building workshops, expert group meetings, training activities and policy advice; develop knowledge products on sustainable foreign direct investment (FDI), innovation, technology cooperation and transfer, innovative and emerging technologies, responsible and

- inclusive business, social enterprise, impact investment and innovative finance for women's entrepreneurship;
- (d) Support member States with measures to maintain trade flows of critical goods in times of global and regional crises, including in the areas of trade facilitation, and support trade digitization, such as paperless and contactless trade, as appropriate;
 - (e) Support member States in formulating policies for sustainable FDI, infrastructure financing and micro-, small and medium-sized enterprises, with a key focus on private sector engagement through the ESCAP Sustainable Business Network and on developing initiatives through the sharing of best sustainability practices and the promotion of measures to support policy exchanges and women entrepreneurs with a view to reducing vulnerabilities;
 - (f) Support regional cooperation and knowledge-sharing platforms and expand expert networks in the areas of trade, investment, technology, innovation and inclusive and sustainable business, including through public-private partnerships, for knowledge transfer and peer learning.
- 19.39 These workstreams will support member States in making progress towards the achievement of Sustainable Development Goals 5, 7 to 9, 11 to 13 and 17.
- 19.40 The above-mentioned work is expected to result in:
- (a) Reduced trade costs and increased participation and competitiveness of companies, especially micro-, small and medium-sized enterprises, in international trade;
 - (b) The adoption by member States of more effective rules and procedures governing trade, leading to more efficient trade outcomes aligned with the Sustainable Development Goals;
 - (c) The adoption by member States of policies and measures aimed at achieving more inclusive and sustainable outcomes of private sector activities, including public-private partnerships;
 - (d) The integration of inclusive and sustainable practices into technology and innovation policies in the region, while mitigating risks related to the use of information and communications technologies;
 - (e) The increased resilience of supply chains by enabling continued trade activities and using technology and innovation to mitigate the impact of crises, as appropriate in a secure manner.

Programme performance in 2025

Countries strengthen trade agreement negotiations through tailored analytics

- 19.41 The Trade Intelligence and Negotiation Adviser is an online tool designed to assist trade policymakers and researchers in carrying out analytical tasks commonly conducted as part of trade agreement negotiations. Since its launch in 2018, the subprogramme has gradually expanded the platform to include additional analytical features and cover an increasing number of economies. It has supported policymakers from more than 15 countries to strengthen their capacities in effectively using the tool to overcome challenges in trade negotiations.
- 19.42 Building on this foundation and at the request of the Government of Cambodia, the subprogramme developed the first dedicated national Trade Intelligence and Negotiation Adviser portal, featuring customized analytical modules for regional trade impact assessment, input-output simulation and market trends and analysis. Training for policymakers was conducted and enhanced national ownership and practical use of the tool. The new features, available on the national portal, also enabled the subprogramme to estimate sex-disaggregated labour impacts of trade measures. Following this pilot of nationalizing trade negotiation support, Bangladesh requested the development of a similar portal, demonstrating growing regional demand for support in strengthening trade negotiation capacities.
- 19.43 Progress towards the objective is presented in the performance measure below (see table 19.7).

Table 19.7
Performance measure

2023 (actual)	2024 (actual)	2025 (actual)
Member States utilize the Trade Intelligence and Negotiation Adviser tool	Member States utilize the Trade Intelligence and Negotiation Adviser tool, which contains expanded functionalities related to legal aspects	Cambodia utilizes the first customized national Trade Intelligence and Negotiation Adviser portal to inform trade negotiations

Planned results for 2027

Result 1: more sustainable and efficient trade processes through increased digital and sustainable trade facilitation measures

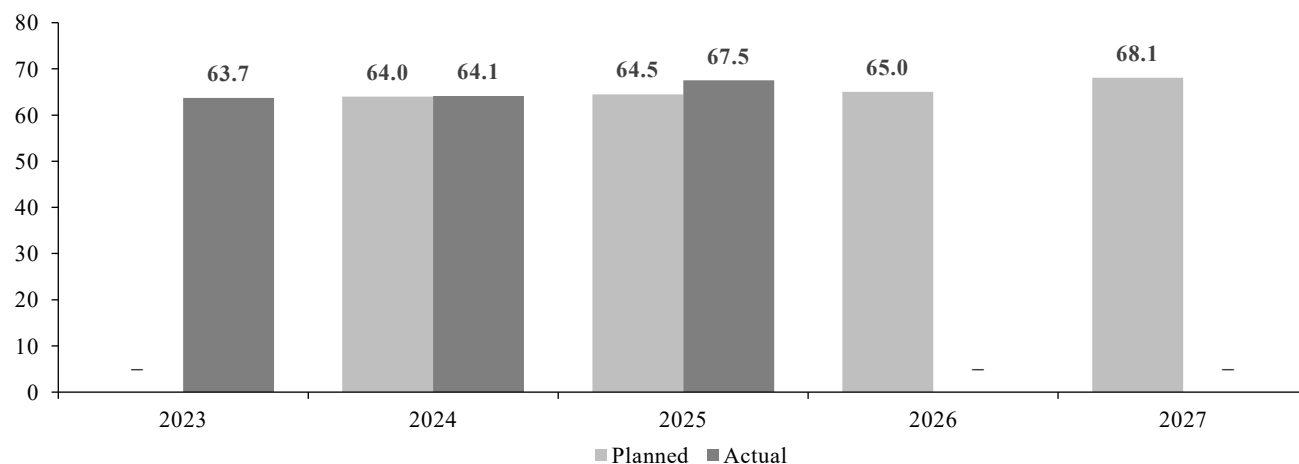
Programme performance in 2025 and target for 2027

- 19.44 The subprogramme's work contributed to a 67.5 per cent implementation rate of digital and sustainable trade facilitation measures in Asia and the Pacific, which exceeded the planned target of 64.5 per cent.
- 19.45 Progress towards the objective and the target for 2027 are presented in the performance measure below (see figure 19.I).

Figure 19.I

Performance measure: implementation rate of digital and sustainable trade facilitation measures in Asia and the Pacific (annual)

(Percentage)



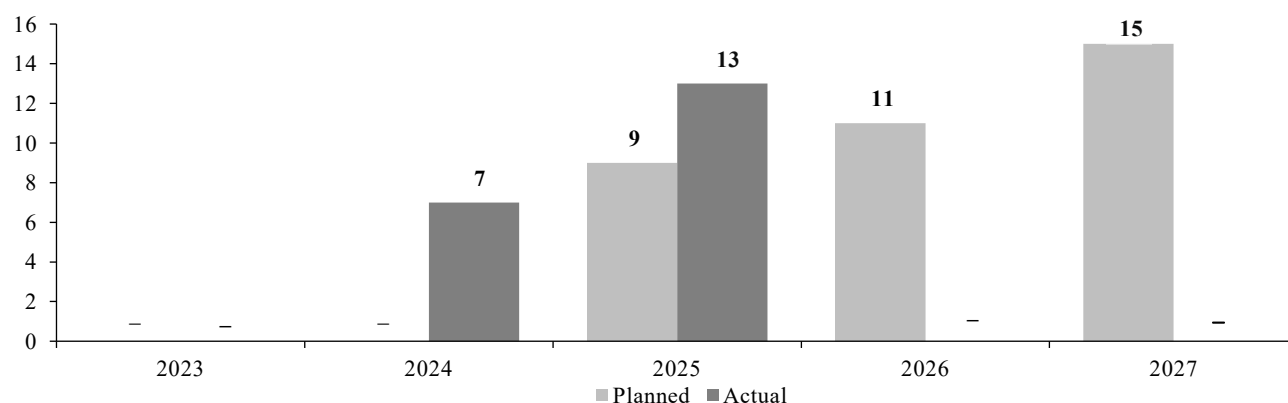
Result 2: investment promotion agencies pledge commitment to advance gender equality through foreign direct investment

Programme performance in 2025 and target for 2027

- 19.46 The subprogramme's work contributed to six additional investment promotion agencies that have formally signed the pledge, for a total of 13 investment promotion agencies, which exceeded the cumulative target of nine investment promotion agencies that have formally signed the pledge.
- 19.47 Progress towards the objective and the target for 2027 are presented in the performance measure below (see figure 19.II).

Figure 19.II

Performance measure: number of investment promotion agencies that have formally signed the pledge (cumulative)



Result 3: improved access to opportunities for technology transfer and knowledge on emerging and innovative technologies

Proposed programme plan for 2027

- 19.48 Policymakers, academia, industry and innovators require reliable access to up-to-date knowledge on emerging technologies and their localization to design policies, support commercialization and strengthen national innovation systems. To address the gap, the subprogramme is advancing the Asia-Pacific technology transfer platform to enhance knowledge-sharing and capacity-building and connect stakeholders to technology transfer opportunities across the region.

Lessons learned and planned change

- 19.49 The lesson for the subprogramme was that digital platforms for technology transfer must be complemented by active facilitation, strong institutional partnerships and structured follow-up to translate virtual collaboration into tangible adoption of technologies. In applying the lesson, the subprogramme will strengthen the functionality of the Asia-Pacific technology transfer platform and the community of practice on climate technologies, and will operationalize the platform through regular engagement with technology providers, seekers, investors and policymakers. It will ensure that technology needs assessments shape platform content and services and will expand collaboration with international partners, academia and the private sector to enrich knowledge and mobilize financing for scale-up.
- 19.50 Expected progress towards the objective is presented in the performance measure below (see table 19.8).

Table 19.8

Performance measure

2023 (actual)	2024 (actual)	2025 (actual)	2026 (planned)	2027 (planned)
Member States proposed the development of the Asia-Pacific technology transfer platform	A working group discussed the design and operation of the platform	Member States use the community of practice on climate technologies as part of the platform to collect knowledge and good practices from regional experts	Technology providers and seekers are increasingly connected through new features on the platform	More than five technologies registered on the platform are transferred to member States

Deliverables

19.51 Table 19.9 lists all deliverables of the subprogramme.

Table 19.9

Subprogramme 2: deliverables for the period 2025–2027, by category and subcategory

Category and subcategory	2025 planned	2025 actual	2026 planned ^a	2027 planned
A. Facilitation of the intergovernmental process and expert bodies				
Parliamentary documentation (number of documents)	17	15	11	17
Reports for:				
1. The Commission	1	1	1	1
2. The Committee on Trade, Investment, Enterprise and Business Innovation	6	6	–	6
3. The Governing Council of the Asian and Pacific Centre for Transfer of Technology	2	2	2	2
4. The Asia-Pacific Trade Agreement Standing Committee	4	–	4	4
5. The Paperless Trade Council of the Framework Agreement on Facilitation of Cross-border Paperless Trade in Asia and the Pacific and the Standing Committee of the Framework Agreement	4	6	4	4
Substantive services for meetings (number of three-hour meetings)	34	23	38	38
Meetings of:				
6. The Committee on Trade, Investment, Enterprise and Business Innovation	6	5	–	5
7. The Governing Council of the Asian and Pacific Centre for Transfer of Technology	4	3	4	4
8. The Asia-Pacific Trade Agreement Standing Committee	8	–	8	8
9. The Paperless Trade Council of the Framework Agreement on Facilitation of Cross-border Paperless Trade in Asia and the Pacific	2	4	4	2
10. The Standing Committee of the Framework Agreement on Facilitation of Cross-border Paperless Trade in Asia and the Pacific	2	5	6	3
11. The expert groups on trade, investment and innovation	8	3	12	12
12. The Executive Council of the ESCAP Sustainable Business Network	2	2	2	2
13. The United Nations Special Programme for the Economies of Central Asia Working Group on Trade	2	1	2	2
B. Generation and transfer of knowledge				
Field and technical cooperation projects (number of projects)	6	20	6	7
14. On the ESCAP Sustainable Business Network	–	–	1	1
15. On trade policy and economic partnership	1	1	1	1
16. On trade facilitation and paperless trade	1	6	1	1
17. On innovation, enterprise and investment	1	11	1	1
18. On new and emerging technologies	3	2	2	3
Seminars, workshops and training events (number of days)	–	–	4	5
19. On technology innovation and the scale-up of new and emerging technologies	–	–	2	3
20. On enabling policies and linkages, including technology and financing mechanisms	–	–	1	1
21. On cross-border cooperation and networking for technology cooperation	–	–	1	1
Publications (number of publications)	3	3	2	2
22. <i>Asia-Pacific Trade and Investment Report</i>	1	1	–	1
23. <i>Studies in Trade, Investment and Innovation</i> series	2	2	1 [2]	1
24. <i>Innovation in Asia and the Pacific</i>	–	–	1	–

Category and subcategory	2025 planned	2025 actual	2026 planned ^a	2027 planned
Technical materials (number of materials)	10	12	9	9
25. Trade, Investment and Innovation Working Paper Series	2	2	2	2
26. Policy briefs on trade, investment and innovation	3	4	2 [3]	2
27. Reports on trade facilitation and paperless trade implementation	1	2	1	1
28. <i>Asia-Pacific Tech Monitor</i>	4	4	4	4

C. Substantive deliverables

Consultation, advice and advocacy: advisory services on trade, investment, innovation, inclusive and sustainable business; consultation on technology cooperation and transfer, and emerging and frontier technologies; advisory support for the task forces of the ESCAP Sustainable Business Network; knowledge management platform on technology transfer; regional knowledge networks linking researchers, policymakers and practitioners in trade, investment, innovation and inclusive and sustainable business, including the Asia-Pacific Research and Training Network on Trade and the United Nations Network of Experts for Paperless Trade and Transport in Asia and the Pacific; side events on trade, investment and innovation at the Asia-Pacific Forum on Sustainable Development and the Commission session.

Databases and substantive digital materials: e-training module on technology transfer; online courses and databases on trade, investment and innovation; the comprehensive trade cost database; the online Trade Intelligence and Negotiation Adviser; trade performance indicators on non-tariff measures; the Asia-Pacific technology transfer platform.

D. Communication deliverables

Outreach programmes, special events and information materials: country fact sheets, multimedia materials and briefings on trade, investment, innovation and inclusive and sustainable business; newsletter and information products on technology cooperation and transfer.

^a Reflects updated planned deliverables for 2026. Values in square brackets represent the number of planned deliverables reflected in A/80/6 (Sect. 19).

Subprogramme 3 Transport

Objective

- 19.52 The objective, to which this subprogramme contributes, is to achieve sustainable transport connectivity, logistics and mobility in the Asia-Pacific region.

Strategy

- 19.53 To contribute to the objective, the subprogramme will:
- (a) Serve as the secretariat for the Intergovernmental Agreement on the Asian Highway Network, the Intergovernmental Agreement on the Trans-Asian Railway Network and the Intergovernmental Agreement on Dry Ports, and provide technical expertise to the intergovernmental deliberations of the relevant working groups, including on operational issues and issues of relevance to landlocked developing countries;
 - (b) Provide technical assistance and conduct related research and analysis on land and maritime transport, with due consideration for the specific needs of landlocked developing countries and small island developing States, focusing on enhanced operational connectivity through promoting knowledge products and best practices, including efficient operational arrangements and harmonized legal frameworks for multimodal transport, and facilitate systematic regional and, as appropriate, interregional dialogue to foster regional and interregional connectivity;
 - (c) Facilitate the exchange of good practices on the utilization of new and emerging technologies, and support the wider deployment of smart transport systems through the development of a

regional road map and by raising awareness through knowledge products and capacity development;

- (d) Undertake policy advocacy and capacity-building in the areas of sustainable urban transport and low greenhouse gas emissions and logistics, including by promoting and facilitating an accelerated transition to affordable, safe, low-emission, clean and energy-efficient transport and environmentally friendly supply chains;
 - (e) Provide technical assistance in the areas of road safety and inclusive transport and mobility, including through a regional plan of action for road safety and regional guidelines addressing accessibility, to support reductions in poverty and inequality and promote inclusive transport for people with different travel requirements, including but not limited to women, children, older persons, low-income transport users, rural inhabitants and persons with disabilities.
- 19.54 These workstreams will support member States in making progress towards the achievement of Sustainable Development Goals 3, 7, 9, 11 to 14 and 17 and the objectives of the new regional action programme for sustainable transport development in Asia and the Pacific for the period 2027–2031.
- 19.55 The above-mentioned work is expected to result in:
- (a) A more sustainable, efficient and resilient transport infrastructure along the regional transport networks (Asian highways, trans-Asian railways and dry ports) and at maritime ports to support freight and, where appropriate, passenger operations that are affordable, safe, accessible and environmentally friendly;
 - (b) Enhanced regional land, maritime and interregional transport connectivity to preserve regional and interregional transport linkages and foster regional cooperation to support interregional and intraregional trade and people connectivity;
 - (c) The formulation and implementation of sustainable transport and mobility policy initiatives in member countries, including the planning and development of urban public transport systems, measures and mechanisms to promote the use of low-greenhouse-gas-emission transport and smart mobility approaches, and measures to improve transport safety and promote inclusive transport in the region.

Programme performance in 2025

Member States increasingly integrate inclusive transport principles into their planning and policymaking processes for more accessible and socially inclusive transport systems in Asia-Pacific cities

- 19.56 Different transport user groups, including low-income households, rural residents, older persons, women and persons with disabilities, all have various travel needs and preferences. Existing transport infrastructure, services and systems in most countries in Asia and the Pacific, however, are not designed for the specific needs of these diverse groups. The subprogramme has worked with member States and other stakeholders to develop guidelines and indicators on enhancing social inclusion and innovations in transport systems in Asia-Pacific cities and to promote accessible and affordable transport systems for all. The development and dissemination of these tools were complemented with capacity-building for transport policymakers, to enable member States to develop and implement inclusive transport policies.
- 19.57 Progress towards the objective is presented in the performance measure below (see table 19.10).

Table 19.10

Performance measure

<i>2023 (actual)</i>	<i>2024 (actual)</i>	<i>2025 (actual)</i>
Enhanced capacity of transport planners and policymakers in four countries (Azerbaijan, the Lao People's Democratic Republic, Mongolia and Nepal) to develop inclusive transport policies for accessible, safe, socially inclusive and innovative transport systems	Inclusive accessibility policies developed in five countries (Fiji, Kiribati, Papua New Guinea, Solomon Islands and Timor-Leste)	Two countries (Papua New Guinea and Timor-Leste) created national indicators to track the progress of social inclusion and transport policies

Planned results for 2027**Result 1: increased efficiency and resilience of transport connectivity and logistics networks in Asia and the Pacific****Programme performance in 2025 and target for 2027**

- 19.58 The subprogramme's work contributed to the adoption by member States of four amendment proposals to the configuration of transport networks, which met the planned target.
- 19.59 Progress towards the objective and the target for 2027 are presented in the performance measure below (see table 19.11).

Table 19.11

Performance measure

<i>2023 (actual)</i>	<i>2024 (actual)</i>	<i>2025 (actual)</i>	<i>2026 (planned)</i>	<i>2027 (planned)</i>
Member States adopted amendments to five Asian Highway routes and two Trans-Asian Railway routes	Three member States shared advance information on their intention to amend the Asian Highway and Trans-Asian Railway routes involving international border crossings	Member States adopted four proposed amendments to the configuration of transport networks	Member States update policy initiatives to increase the resilience and efficiency of Asian Highway and Trans-Asian Railway routes	Member States consider further updates to the Asian Highway and the Trans-Asian Railway networks

Result 2: accelerated transition to low-emission transport**Programme performance in 2025 and target for 2027**

- 19.60 The subprogramme's work contributed to three member States establishing national vertical coordination mechanisms, which did not meet the planned target of four member States. The target was not met as one country requires more time to review the policy approach to electric mobility.
- 19.61 Progress towards the objective and the target for 2027 are presented in the performance measure below (see table 19.12).

Table 19.12
Performance measure

2023 (actual)	2024 (actual)	2025 (actual)	2026 (planned)	2027 (planned)
–	20 member States joined the Asia-Pacific initiative on electric mobility	Three member States (the Lao People's Democratic Republic, the Philippines and Tajikistan) established national vertical coordination mechanisms to accelerate their transition to electric mobility	At least two member States establish pilot electric bus routes Member States consider a regional action plan on low-emission transport at the Ministerial Conference on Transport	Three additional member States join the Asia-Pacific initiative on electric mobility

Result 3: strengthened regional cooperation for sustainable, resilient and inclusive transport development

Proposed programme plan for 2027

- 19.62 The subprogramme supported member States in advancing sustainable, resilient and inclusive transport in Asia and the Pacific through the adoption and implementation of various regional action programmes. These medium-term strategies serve as a guiding framework for regional cooperation on sustainable transport development in the region.

Lessons learned and planned change

- 19.63 The lesson for the subprogramme was that the specific challenges and priorities of least developed countries, landlocked developing countries and small island developing States needed to be better addressed in the new regional action programme, for the period 2027–2031. In applying the lesson, the subprogramme will enhance its support to countries in special situations in achieving national, regional and global sustainable transport goals, including by scaling up the implementation of sustainable, resilient and inclusive transport policies and translating them into concrete actions; providing capacity-building activities tailored to member States' needs; and strengthening knowledge exchange, peer-to-peer learning and South-South and triangular cooperation.
- 19.64 Expected progress towards the objective is presented in the performance measure below (see table 19.13).

Table 19.13
Performance measure

2023 (actual)	2024 (actual)	2025 (actual)	2026 (planned)	2027 (planned)
–	–	Member States initiated the evaluation of the implementation of the Regional Action Programme for Sustainable Transport Development in Asia and the Pacific	Member States consider the adoption of a regional action programme for the period 2027–2031 that reflects their priorities and challenges, including those of	Member States initiate the implementation of the regional action programme

2023 (actual)	2024 (actual)	2025 (actual)	2026 (planned)	2027 (planned)
		(2022–2026) and discussed areas to be added or strengthened in the next iteration of the Programme	countries in special situations, at the fifth session of the Ministerial Conference on Transport	

Deliverables

19.65 Table 19.14 lists all deliverables of the subprogramme.

Table 19.14

Subprogramme 3: deliverables for the period 2025–2027, by category and subcategory

Category and subcategory	2025 planned	2025 actual	2026 planned ^a	2027 planned
A. Facilitation of the intergovernmental process and expert bodies				
Parliamentary documentation (number of documents)	1	1	4	1
Reports for:				
1. The Commission	1	1	1	1
2. The Ministerial Conference on Transport	–	–	3	–
Substantive services for meetings (number of three-hour meetings)	28	21	26	28
Meetings of:				
3. The Ministerial Conference on Transport	–	–	10	–
4. The Working Group on the Asian Highway Network	4	4	–	4
5. The Working Group on the Trans-Asian Railway Network	4	4	–	4
6. The Working Group on Dry Ports	4	4	–	4
7. The United Nations Special Programme for the Economies of Central Asia Working Group on Sustainable Transport, Transit and Connectivity	4	–	4	4
8. Expert groups on transport connectivity and logistics	8	5	4	4
9. Expert groups on mobility	4	4	8	8
B. Generation and transfer of knowledge				
Field and technical cooperation projects (number of projects)	8	17	8	8
10. On transport connectivity and logistics	4	6	4	4
11. On mobility	4	11	4	4
Seminars, workshops and training events (number of days)	1	5	–	–
12. On transport connectivity and logistics	1	5	–	–
Publications (number of publications)	2	2	2	2
13. On transport developments in Asia and the Pacific	1	–	1	–
14. On transport connectivity, logistics and mobility	–	1	–	2
15. <i>Transport and Communications Bulletin for Asia and the Pacific</i>	1	1	1	–
Technical materials (number of materials)	3	5	2	2
16. On transport connectivity and logistics	2	4	1	1
17. On mobility	1	1	1 [2]	1

Category and subcategory	2025 planned	2025 actual	2026 planned ^a	2027 planned
C. Substantive deliverables				
Consultation, advice and advocacy: side events on transport at the Asia-Pacific Forum on Sustainable Development.				
Databases and substantive digital materials: Asian Highway database, the Trans-Asian Railway Network and the network of dry ports.				
D. Communication deliverables				
Outreach programmes, special events and information materials: infographics on road safety for regional and global access.				

^a Reflects updated planned deliverables for 2026. Values in square brackets represent the number of planned deliverables reflected in A/80/6 (Sect. 19).

Subprogramme 4 Environment and development and disaster risk reduction and management

Objective

- 19.66 The objective, to which this subprogramme contributes, is to enhance the environmental sustainability of development, reduce and manage disaster risks and improve human well-being in urban and rural environments.

Strategy

- 19.67 To contribute to the objective, the subprogramme will:
- (a) Support member States in the development of ambitious climate action policies and plans for sustainable environment and development, including local actions in urban areas, aligned with the decisions adopted by the Commission and the Committee on Environment and Development and various multilateral environmental agreements;
 - (b) Promote regional cooperation on air quality management, including through the operationalization of the Regional Action Programme on Air Pollution, to provide opportunities for partnership-building, dialogues and the exchange of best practices, complemented by technical support to member States, in collaboration with relevant United Nations and international organizations;
 - (c) Build the capacity of national, subnational and local officials to strengthen sustainable urban planning processes to localize the Sustainable Development Goals, adopt urban resilience and smart city systems, develop climate-resilient infrastructure and increase awareness of urban solutions, including nature-based solutions, and ecosystem-based approaches to reduce the environmental impacts of urbanization;
 - (d) Leverage subregional and regional cooperation and build the capacity of countries in multi-hazard disaster risk reduction, adaptation and sustainable, low-emission and climate-resilient development pathways, including risk-informed development planning, through the activities of the Asian and Pacific Centre for the Development of Disaster Information Management, and make full use of early warning systems and regional platforms such as the ESCAP Risk and Resilience Portal, the ESCAP multi-donor trust fund for tsunami, disaster and climate preparedness and the Asia-Pacific Disaster Resilience Network;
 - (e) Support regional cooperation to protect and sustainably use ocean and marine ecosystems, including by coordinating the regional implementation of the United Nations Decade of Ocean Science for Sustainable Development, and the follow-up to the outcomes of the third United Nations Ocean Conference by, inter alia, providing regional and multi-stakeholder dialogue platforms to support region-wide initiatives and global processes, including ocean-based action to combat climate change;

- (f) Promote subregional dialogue on institutionalizing participatory approaches in environmental matters and disaster risk reduction and management, including through the sharing of good practices, the development of common approaches and South-South cooperation;
 - (g) Strengthen the adoption of sustainable agricultural technologies, testing procedures and practices in the region in support of food security, the resilience of rural communities and air quality management through the activities of the Centre for Sustainable Agricultural Mechanization;
 - (h) Further build the resilience of human and institutional capacity by providing assistance in the facilitation of inclusive use of digital solutions, such as the use of actionable disaster risk analytics and the provision of targeted solutions for the special needs of countries that face a high disaster risk.
- 19.68 The above-mentioned strategy will help to support member States in their progress towards the achievement of Sustainable Development Goals 1, 2, 3, 5, 6, 11, 13, 15 and 17.
- 19.69 The above-mentioned work is expected to result in:
- (a) Enhanced action by member States to address environmental challenges, including through sustainable, low-emission and climate-resilient development that is in compliance with various multilateral environmental agreements;
 - (b) Enhanced action by member States to improve air quality with the support of collaborative actions developed in line with the Regional Action Programme on Air Pollution;
 - (c) Increased sustainability and resilience of communities and a reduction of the negative impacts of urbanization;
 - (d) Strengthened subregional cooperation for participatory approaches in environmental matters;
 - (e) Strengthened regional and multi-stakeholder partnerships for the conservation and sustainable use of the ocean and marine resources;
 - (f) Strengthened capacities of member States to assess, reduce and manage disaster risks across multiple hazards, including those related to climate change and geological hazards, in line with the Sendai Framework for Disaster Risk Reduction 2015–2030.

Programme performance in 2025

Accelerated implementation of climate action

- 19.70 Several member States have made critical steps towards enhancing global climate ambition and transparency. The subprogramme provided targeted support to landlocked developing countries, including to Bhutan in developing its enhanced transparency framework, which strengthens those countries' capacity to track and report climate actions in line with the Paris Agreement. Similarly, the subprogramme assisted Papua New Guinea in updating its nationally determined contribution to articulate more ambitious climate goals and integrate them into national planning. These efforts are the result of sustained collaboration, technical guidance and capacity-building initiatives provided by the subprogramme that empower both countries to meet international climate commitments. This approach highlighted the importance of tailored support in enabling developing countries to lead on climate action and transparency.
- 19.71 Progress towards the objective is presented in the performance measure below (see table 19.15).

Table 19.15
Performance measure

2023 (actual)	2024 (actual)	2025 (actual)
–	Bhutan and Papua New Guinea developed projects to build capacity for developing national greenhouse gas emissions inventories	Bhutan and Papua New Guinea increased their capacity and understanding for the development of their enhanced transparency frameworks to support implementation of their commitments under the Paris Agreement, and Papua New Guinea updated its nationally determined contribution ahead of the thirtieth session of the Conference of the Parties to the United Nations Framework Convention on Climate Change

Planned results for 2027

Result 1: member States in Asia and the Pacific increase cooperation to advance participatory approaches on environmental matters

Programme performance in 2025 and target for 2027

- 19.72 The subprogramme's work contributed to the development and adoption of a subregional declaration by 10 member States to promote participatory approaches on environmental matters (the Association of Southeast Asian Nations (ASEAN) Declaration on the Right to a Safe, Clean, Healthy and Sustainable Environment), which met the planned target of member States taking steps to institutionalize modalities for participation.
- 19.73 Progress towards the objective and the target for 2027 are presented in the performance measure below (see table 19.16).

Table 19.16
Performance measure

2023 (actual)	2024 (actual)	2025 (actual)	2026 (planned)	2027 (planned)
Member States enhanced subregional cooperation to promote participatory approaches	Member States developed a draft subregional declaration to promote participatory approaches	10 member States developed and adopted a subregional declaration to promote participatory approaches on environmental matters	Member States develop an instrument to institutionalize modalities for participatory approaches	Member States hold consultations and take steps towards national implementation of subregional instruments to promote participatory approaches

Result 2: increased regional cooperation on ocean-based climate actions, including through ecosystem-based approaches and nature-based solutions

Programme performance in 2025 and target for 2027

- 19.74 The subprogramme's work contributed to member States implementing the Initiative for Regional Cooperation on Ocean-based Climate Action, which strengthens regional actions and dialogue on conserving marine ecosystems, which met the planned target.

- 19.75 Progress towards the objective and the target for 2027 are presented in the performance measure below (see table 19.17).

Table 19.17
Performance measure

2023 (actual)	2024 (actual)	2025 (actual)	2026 (planned)	2027 (planned)
–	Member States identified options and modalities for strengthening regional cooperation on conserving marine ecosystems	Member States implemented the Initiative for Regional Cooperation on Ocean-based Climate Action, which strengthens regional actions and dialogue on conserving marine ecosystems	Member States agree on regional actions to follow up on the outcomes of the third United Nations Ocean Conference, including on carbon dioxide sequestration and storage	Member States implement ocean actions in preparation for the fourth United Nations Ocean Conference

Result 3: regional cooperation, partnerships and initiatives on sustainable urban development are expanded and enhanced

Proposed programme plan for 2027

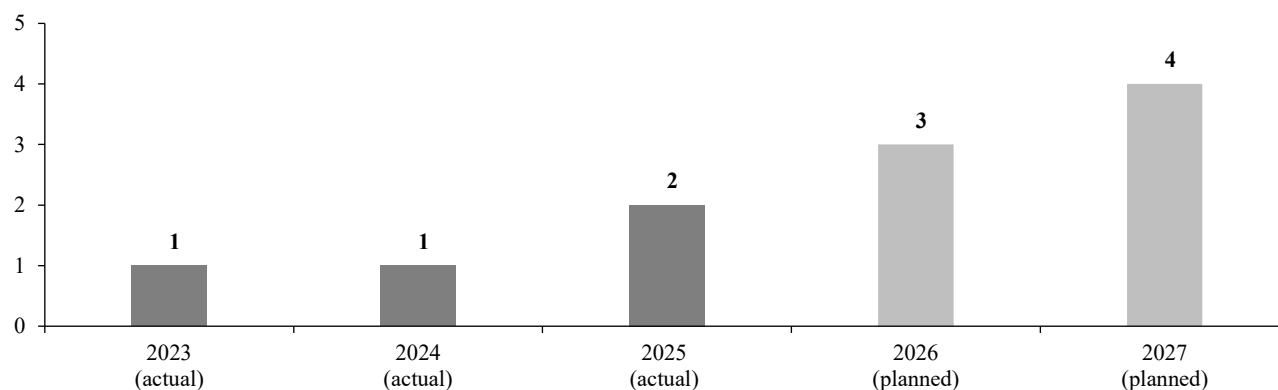
- 19.76 The subprogramme promotes multi-stakeholder dialogue and the exchange of sustainable urban solutions through the organization of regional forums on urban development, and facilitates partnerships to localize the Sustainable Development Goals, resulting in local actions and enhanced coordination among national and subnational authorities.

Lessons learned and planned change

- 19.77 The lesson for the subprogramme was that emerging opportunities to enhance cooperation among national and subnational authorities could advance the progress towards creating sustainable cities and communities. In applying the lesson, the subprogramme will design programmes and initiatives that engage a wide range of stakeholders and strengthen multilevel governance on climate and sustainable urban development to support the implementation of local actions. The subprogramme will further increase its efforts to promote multilevel governance through capacity-building and initiatives that will enhance capacities, regional cooperation and partnerships of local governments.
- 19.78 Expected progress towards the objective is presented in the performance measure below (see figure 19.III).

Figure 19.III

Performance measure: number of multi-stakeholder partnerships on sustainable urban development (cumulative)



Deliverables

19.79 Table 19.18 lists all deliverables of the subprogramme.

Table 19.18

Subprogramme 4: deliverables for the period 2025–2027, by category and subcategory

Category and subcategory	2025 planned	2025 actual	2026 planned ^a	2027 planned
A. Facilitation of the intergovernmental process and expert bodies				
Parliamentary documentation (number of documents)	1	2	2	4
Reports for:				
1. The Commission	1	2	1	2
2. The Committee on Environment and Development	—	—	1	—
3. The Committee on Disaster Risk Reduction	—	—	—	2
Substantive services for meetings (number of three-hour meetings)	17	19	26	41
Meetings of:				
4. The Committee on Environment and Development	—	—	5	—
5. The Committee on Disaster Risk Reduction	—	—	—	5
6. The Technical Expert Group on Environment and Development	—	3	3 [4]	2
7. The Governing Council of the Centre for Sustainable Agricultural Mechanization	2	2	2	2
8. The Governing Council of the Asian and Pacific Centre for the Development of Disaster Information Management	—	—	—	2
9. The Asian and Pacific Network for Testing of Agricultural Machinery	5	6	5	5
10. The policy forum of the Seoul Initiative on Environmentally Sustainable Economic Growth	—	—	6	4
11. The World Meteorological Organization (WMO)/ESCAP Panel on Tropical Cyclones	—	—	—	4
12. The ESCAP/WMO Typhoon Committee	—	—	—	4
13. Expert groups for the implementation of internationally agreed agendas related to the environment and development	2	4	1 [2]	1
14. Expert groups on sustainable and resilient cities in the Asia-Pacific region	8	4	4 [8]	4
15. Expert groups on disaster risk reduction	—	—	—	2
16. The Asia-Pacific Urban Forum	—	—	—	6

Category and subcategory	2025 planned	2025 actual	2026 planned ^a	2027 planned
B. Generation and transfer of knowledge				
Field and technical cooperation projects (number of projects)	8	17	10	9
17. Asian and Pacific Centre for the Development of Disaster Information Management	—	—	—	1
18. On disaster risk reduction	—	—	—	1
19. On the sustainable management of natural resources	1	3	1	1
20. On sustainable urban development	2	5	2	2
21. On sustainable agricultural mechanization	2	4	2	2
22. On sustainable economic growth	1	—	1	1
23. To support countries in Asia-Pacific to meet commitments to the Paris Agreement	—	—	1	—
24. On air pollution	1	4	2	1
25. On participatory approaches to environmental matters	1	1	1	—
Seminars, workshops and training events (number of days)	10	5	5	4
26. On the integrated management of straw residue	1	2	1	1
27. On strengthening human resources for sustainable agricultural mechanization	1	1	1	1
28. On promoting sustainable agricultural mechanization through South-South cooperation	2	2	2	2
29. Asia-Pacific Day for the Ocean	1	—	1	—
30. Asia-Pacific Climate Week	5	—	—	—
Publications (number of publications)	1	1	1	2
31. On the environment and development	1	1	1	1
32. <i>Asia-Pacific Disaster Report</i>	—	—	—	1
Technical materials (number of materials)	4	9	4	9
33. On the environment and development	1	6	1 [2]	2
34. On agricultural machinery	3	3	3	3
35. Policy briefs and guidelines on disaster information management	—	—	—	3
36. On disaster risk reduction	—	—	—	1
C. Substantive deliverables				
Consultation, advice and advocacy: advisory services on disaster risk reduction and resilience; side events at the Asia-Pacific Forum on Sustainable Development.				
Databases and substantive digital materials: ESCAP Risk and Resilience Portal; digital material for the development and management of disaster information databases and spatial data infrastructure.				
D. Communication deliverables				
Outreach programmes, special events and information materials: information material on agricultural mechanization; the International Day of Clean Air for blue skies, World Cities Day and World Habitat Day.				
Digital platforms and multimedia content: multimedia training content on disaster information management.				

^a Reflects updated planned deliverables for 2026. Values in square brackets represent the number of planned deliverables reflected in A/80/6 (Sect. 19).

Subprogramme 5 Information and communications technology and space applications

Objective

- 19.80 The objective, to which this subprogramme contributes, is to strengthen regional cooperation on information and communications technology (ICT) and space technology applications for sustainable development in Asia and the Pacific through the sharing of information and best practices.

Strategy

- 19.81 To contribute to the objective, the subprogramme will support member States in making progress towards the achievement of Sustainable Development Goals 1, 4, 5, 9 to 11, 13 to 15 and 17 by developing norms for secure and inclusive digital connectivity and geospatial data-sharing, supported by policy analysis and evidence-based research. Specifically, the subprogramme will:
- (a) Build capacity, especially of countries in special situations, in the above-mentioned areas, anchored in regional cooperation mechanisms that promote technical cooperation through the South-South and North-South modalities and are augmented by the programmes of the Asian and Pacific Training Centre for Information and Communication Technology for Development;
 - (b) Promote regional policy dialogue, knowledge exchange and cooperation on transboundary challenges related to connectivity, science, technology and innovation for disaster resilience;
 - (c) Carry out studies on the digital divide, assess policy and regulatory frameworks and provide capacity-building and policy recommendations for digital inclusion and transformation, supplemented by advocacy, networking and partnerships in support of regionally agreed frameworks, including the action plan for implementing the Asia-Pacific Information Superhighway initiative for the period 2027–2030;
 - (d) Guided by the Jakarta Ministerial Declaration on Space Applications for Sustainable Development in Asia and the Pacific and the Asia-Pacific Plan of Action on Space Applications for Sustainable Development (2018–2030), assist member States in harnessing recent advances in space technology applications and geospatial data, facilitate timely and expanded access to space-derived geospatial data, pool expertise and resources at the regional and subregional levels, promote the sharing of knowledge and good practices and create synergies with other existing regional initiatives, as appropriate and upon their request.
- 19.82 The above-mentioned work is expected to result in:
- (a) The bridging of the digital divide, and the appropriate and secure use of digital solutions for transformation;
 - (b) Enhanced applications by member States of integrated geospatial information to support transformative adaptation and accelerate the implementation of the Sustainable Development Goals.

Programme performance in 2025

Strengthened implementation of Early Warnings for All

- 19.83 The subprogramme strengthened the implementation of the Early Warnings for All initiative by scaling up regional cooperation to support the initiative and leveraged the ESCAP multi-donor trust fund for tsunami, disaster and climate preparedness. The subprogramme has delivered downscaled climate projection data and conducted training on impact-based forecasting to enhance capacities for anticipatory action in Cambodia, the Lao People's Democratic Republic, Maldives, Nepal and Tajikistan, all of which are Early Warnings for All pilot countries. With the support of the trust fund, countries with an Indian Ocean coastline and countries with a Pacific Ocean coastline completed capacity assessments and adopted a standard methodology for measuring tsunami preparedness across ocean basins. Three additional strategic studies, namely, the 2025 evaluation of the trust fund, a 20-year cost-benefit analysis and a regional multi-hazard coastal vulnerability assessment, were also endorsed by the Advisory Council to the trust fund and informed the trust fund strategy for the period 2025–2030.
- 19.84 Progress towards the objective is presented in the performance measure below (see table 19.19).

Table 19.19
Performance measure

2023 (actual)	2024 (actual)	2025 (actual)
—	13 out of 15 Asian countries with an Indian Ocean coastline participated in the 2024 tsunami preparedness capacity assessment in the Indian Ocean	32 out of 34 Asia-Pacific countries with a Pacific Ocean coastline participated in the 2025 tsunami preparedness capacity assessment in the Pacific Ocean Standard methodology for assessing regional tsunami preparedness adopted across two ocean basins

Planned results for 2027

Result 1: increased adoption of digitally driven innovations to enable transformative adaptation to climate change

Programme performance in 2025 and target for 2027

- 19.85 The subprogramme's work contributed to the Lao People's Democratic Republic and Mongolia making progress in achieving transformative adaptation in agriculture and the energy sector, which met the planned target.
- 19.86 Progress towards the objective and the target for 2027 are presented in the performance measure below (see table 19.20).

Table 19.20
Performance measure

2023 (actual)	2024 (actual)	2025 (actual)	2026 (planned)	2027 (planned)
Member States accessed an updated version of disaster risk data analytics	Bhutan and Nepal made progress in achieving transformative adaptation in agriculture and the energy sector	The Lao People's Democratic Republic and Mongolia made progress in achieving transformative adaptation in agriculture and the energy sector	Member States gain access to a database of climate change adaptation best practices to enhance adaptation planning at the national and regional levels	Two member States draw on the information in the database of climate change adaptation best practices to enhance their adaptation planning at the national and regional levels

Result 2: scaled up geospatial applications by countries in special situations for achieving the 2030 Agenda

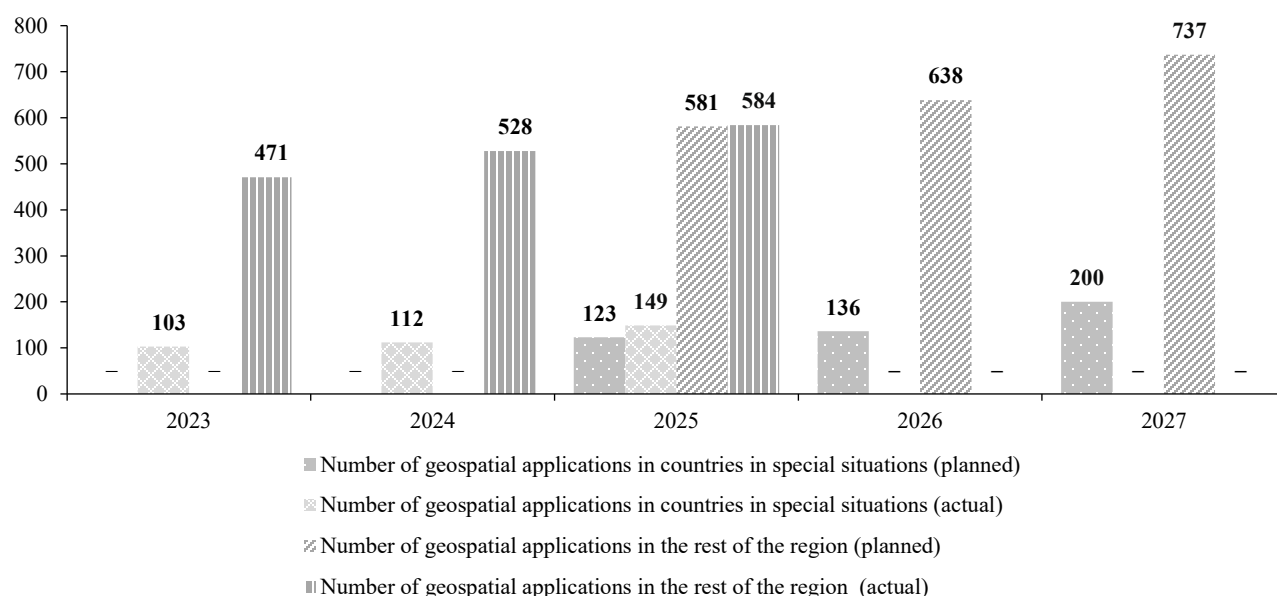
Programme performance in 2025 and target for 2027

- 19.87 The subprogramme's work contributed to an increase in the number of geospatial applications for sustainable development, for a total of 149 in countries in special situations and 584 in the rest of the region, which exceeded the planned targets of 123 in countries in special situations and 581 in the rest of the region.

- 19.88 Progress towards the objective and the target for 2027 are presented in the performance measure below (see figure 19.IV).

Figure 19.IV

Performance measure: number of geospatial applications in Asia and the Pacific (cumulative)



Result 3: strengthened regional cooperation on leveraging the application of emerging technologies, especially artificial intelligence

Proposed programme plan for 2027

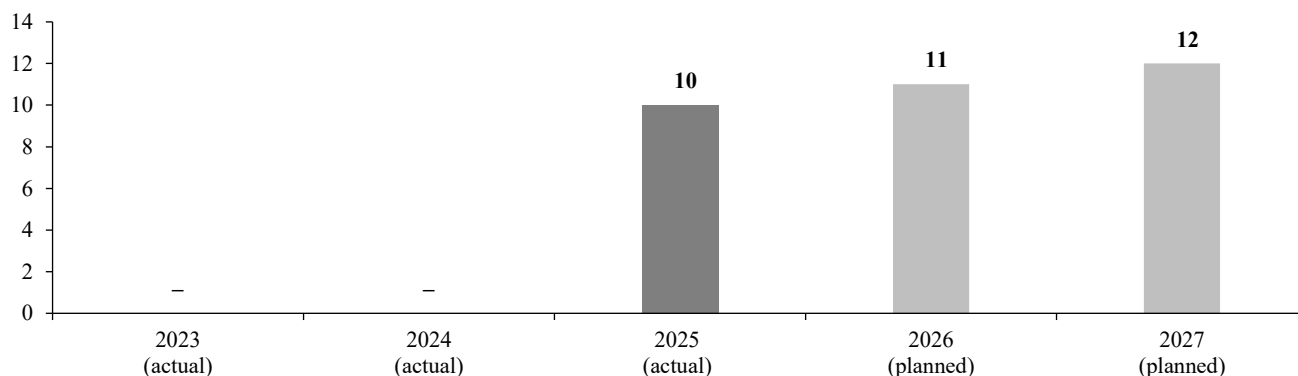
- 19.89 The Asia-Pacific region has witnessed a surge in demand for emerging technologies, especially artificial intelligence, to drive digital transformation. To enable developing economies, particularly the countries in special situations, to fully harness these technologies, the subprogramme leveraged the Asia-Pacific Information Superhighway platform to foster regional cooperation, enabling the sharing of best practices and technical expertise. Through capacity-building initiatives and intercountry knowledge exchange, the subprogramme supported inclusive digital transformation, ensuring that no country is left behind.

Lessons learned and planned change

- 19.90 The lesson for the subprogramme was that the Asia-Pacific Information Superhighway platform serves as an effective regional mechanism for sharing good practices and coordinating stakeholders' national initiatives. In applying the lesson, the subprogramme will promote regional cooperation on leveraging the application of emerging technologies among Asia-Pacific economies through an action plan for implementing the Asia-Pacific Information Superhighway initiative for the period 2027–2030. In particular, the new action plan will include targeted capacity-building and knowledge products on digital priorities for countries in special situations.
- 19.91 Expected progress towards the objective is presented in the performance measure below (see figure 19.V).

Figure 19.V

Performance measure: number of Economic and Social Commission for Asia and the Pacific members and associate members that discussed and agreed to prioritize regional cooperation on leveraging emerging technologies for digital transformation (cumulative)



Deliverables

19.92 Table 19.21 lists all deliverables of the subprogramme.

Table 19.21

Subprogramme 5: deliverables for the period 2025–2027, by category and subcategory

Category and subcategory	2025 planned	2025 actual	2026 planned ^a	2027 planned
A. Facilitation of the intergovernmental process and expert bodies				
Parliamentary documentation (number of documents)	4	5	4	1
Reports for:				
1. The Commission	2	2	2	1
2. The Committee on Disaster Risk Reduction	2	3	—	—
3. The Committee on Information and Communications Technology, Science, Technology and Innovation	—	—	2	—
Substantive services for meetings (number of three-hour meetings)	28	24	28	14
Meetings of:				
4. The Committee on Information and Communications Technology, Science, Technology and Innovation	—	—	5	—
5. The Committee on Disaster Risk Reduction	6	5	—	—
6. The fifth Ministerial Conference on Space Applications for Sustainable Development in Asia and the Pacific	—	—	4	—
7. The Governing Council of the Asian and Pacific Training Centre for Information and Communication Technology for Development	1	1	1	1
8. The Governing Council of the Asian and Pacific Centre for the Development of Disaster Information Management	1	2	2	—
9. The United Nations Special Programme for the Economies of Central Asia Working Group on Innovation and Technology for Sustainable Development	4	1	2	2
10. The WMO/ESCAP Panel on Tropical Cyclones	4	4	4	—
11. The Intergovernmental Consultative Committee on the Regional Space Applications Programme for Sustainable Development	4	5	4	4
12. The ESCAP/WMO Typhoon Committee	4	6	4	—

Part V Regional cooperation for development

<i>Category and subcategory</i>	<i>2025 planned</i>	<i>2025 actual</i>	<i>2026 planned^a</i>	<i>2027 planned</i>
13. The Asia-Pacific Information Superhighway Steering Committee	—	—	2	—
14. Expert groups on disaster risk reduction	4	—	—	—
15. The Regional Committee of United Nations Global Geospatial Information Management for Asia and the Pacific	—	—	—	3
16. The expert group on promoting digital transformation and emerging technology solutions for digital public services in the region	—	—	—	2
17. The expert group on innovative geospatial applications for the implementation of the Sustainable Development Goals	—	—	—	2
B. Generation and transfer of knowledge				
Field and technical cooperation projects (number of projects)	7	17	8	5
18. Asian and Pacific Centre for the Development of Disaster Information Management	1	1	1	—
19. On disaster risk reduction	1	3	1	—
20. On promoting ICT connectivity	2	7	2	1
21. On space technology applications	2	5	3	3
22. Asian and Pacific Training Centre for Information and Communication Technology for Development	1	1	1	1
Seminars, workshops and training events (number of days)	—	—	15	14
23. On strengthening ICT human capacity for inclusive and sustainable development	—	—	14	14
24. On space applications ^b	—	—	1 [2]	—
Publications (number of publications)	2	2	2	—
25. <i>Asia-Pacific Disaster Report</i>	1	1	—	—
26. Compendium on geospatial practices for sustainable development	—	—	1	—
27. On digital transformation for sustainable development	1	1	1	—
Technical materials (number of materials)	6	7	6	3
28. Policy briefs and guidelines on disaster information management	2	2	3	—
29. On disaster risk reduction	1	1	1	—
30. Policy briefs and working papers on ICT, including infrastructure and connectivity	2	2	2	2
31. Policy brief on geospatial information applications	1	2	— [1]	—
32. Working paper on exploring the integration of digital innovations and geospatial data for managing natural hazards	—	—	—	1
C. Substantive deliverables				
Consultation, advice and advocacy: advice to the task forces of the ESCAP Sustainable Business Network; advice for committees and consultations with organizations on issues related to disaster risk reduction, space applications and ICT; briefing notes on digital development for senior government officials from ICT-related ministries and agencies; advice on data governance for risk-informed development.				
Databases and substantive digital materials: digital materials on space technology applications for regional and global access; geospatial practices database and dashboard with 50 new data entries and 10 institutional users.				
D. Communication deliverables				
Outreach programmes, special events and information materials: International Day of Science, Technology and Innovation for the South.				
Digital platforms and multimedia content: content for the Asian and Pacific Training Centre for Information and Communication Technology for Development Virtual Academy.				

^a Reflects updated planned deliverables for 2026. Values in square brackets represent the number of planned deliverables reflected in A/80/6 (Sect. 19).

^b The former meeting of an ad hoc expert group on space applications will be delivered as a seminar in 2026.

Subprogramme 6

Social development

Objective

- 19.93 The objective, to which this subprogramme contributes, is to realize inclusive and equitable societies that protect, empower and leave no one behind in Asia and the Pacific, with a focus on population and development, social protection, disability inclusion, and gender equality and the empowerment of women.

Strategy

- 19.94 To contribute to the objective, the subprogramme will bring together Governments on critical issues related to social development in the region and inform these intergovernmental processes through analysis and by drawing upon the complementary strengths of ESCAP through its regional convening power and the capacity of United Nations agencies, funds and programmes to support national implementation to advance the Sustainable Development Goals. Specifically, the subprogramme will:
- (a) Support Governments in the continued implementation of the Programme of Action of the International Conference on Population and Development, the Madrid International Plan of Action on Ageing and the Global Compact for Safe, Orderly and Regular Migration by strengthening the evidence base with regard to population and development issues, with a focus on ageing, migration and population dynamics, poverty reduction and leaving no one behind;
 - (b) Facilitate the monitoring of the implementation of the Asian and Pacific Ministerial Declaration on Population and Development through the framework that was endorsed at the sixth session of the Committee on Social Development;
 - (c) In line with the Action Plan to Strengthen Regional Cooperation on Social Protection in Asia and the Pacific, consolidate national progress and experiences related to extending social protection coverage in periodic progress reports; develop a regional platform for member States to share good practices; and provide new and innovative analytical tools and products, as well as capacity-development tools and training sessions to Governments;
 - (d) Conduct research and analysis and provide capacity-building support to member States on building disability-inclusive economies and societies, guided by the Convention on the Rights of Persons with Disabilities, the Incheon Strategy to “Make the Right Real” for Persons with Disabilities in Asia and the Pacific, and the Jakarta Declaration on the Asian and Pacific Decade of Persons with Disabilities, 2023–2032, and support other subprogrammes in mainstreaming disability inclusion;
 - (e) Follow up on the outcomes of the Asia-Pacific regional review of the implementation of the Beijing Declaration and Platform for Action by supporting Governments in accelerating the implementation of the Beijing Declaration and Platform for Action;
 - (f) Provide technical assistance in developing policies in the context of economic empowerment and entrepreneurship for women and support other subprogrammes in mainstreaming a gender perspective;
 - (g) Provide knowledge products, seminars and technical advice on addressing women’s unpaid care burden and designing strategies and policy initiatives to improve the care economy;
 - (h) Provide support to member States in identifying the population groups that are at the highest risk of being left behind through its Leave No One Behind methodology, analytical reports and capacity-building.
- 19.95 The above-mentioned work will help to support member States, in particular countries in special situations, in their progress towards the achievement of Sustainable Development Goals 1, 3, 4, 5, 8, 10, 11 and 17.
- 19.96 The above-mentioned work is expected to result in:
- (a) The development of regional frameworks for social development;

- (b) The development of responsive policies and programmes in the domain of population dynamics and social development;
- (c) Enhanced skills and knowledge to enable countries to design and implement inclusive social protection policies, including to address the impact of rapid demographic transitions and climate change;
- (d) Improved national policies and strategies to advance gender equality and women's empowerment, including through measures to improve the care economy and reduce women's unpaid care burden;
- (e) Improved national policies and programmes in support of disability-inclusive development.

Programme performance in 2025

Strengthened regional dialogue and engagement on and joint review of safe, orderly and regular migration in Asia and the Pacific

- 19.97 With international migration contributing significantly to socioeconomic development in Asia and the Pacific, the subprogramme, in close collaboration with the International Organization for Migration and other United Nations entities, guided a review process that culminated in the Asia-Pacific Regional Review of Implementation of the Global Compact for Safe, Orderly and Regular Migration, convened in Bangkok from 4 to 6 February 2025. The intergovernmental meeting brought together 30 ESCAP member States, 20 international organizations and about 100 civil society organizations. The meeting provided an opportunity for Governments to assess implementation of the Global Compact for Safe, Orderly and Regular Migration and exchange valuable lessons. Through stakeholder consultations and side events, the meeting ensured a whole-of-society and whole-of-government approach to the regional review.
- 19.98 Progress towards the objective is presented in the performance measure below (see table 19.22).

Table 19.22

Performance measure

2023 (actual)	2024 (actual)	2025 (actual)
Member States assessed progress and identified priorities of enhancing implementation of the Global Compact for Safe, Orderly and Regular Migration	Member States had access to the <i>Asia-Pacific Migration Report</i> 2024, which summarizes progress and lessons learned in the implementation of the Global Compact for Safe, Orderly and Regular Migration	30 member States reported on progress, shared lessons learned in the implementation of the Global Compact since 2022 and adopted a Chair's summary identifying regional priorities at the Asia-Pacific Regional Review of Implementation of the Global Compact for Safe, Orderly and Regular Migration to inform the second International Migration Review Forum in 2026

Planned results for 2027

Result 1: member States develop policy measures on valuing and investing in the care economy

Programme performance in 2025 and target for 2027

- 19.99 The subprogramme's work contributed to the inclusion of care as one of the eight strategic priorities in the five-year Lao women's development plan in the Lao People's Democratic Republic and the launch of the Timor-Leste National Working Group on Care, which met the planned target.

- 19.100 Progress towards the objective and the target for 2027 are presented in the performance measure below (see table 19.23).

Table 19.23

Performance measure

<i>2023 (actual)</i>	<i>2024 (actual)</i>	<i>2025 (actual)</i>	<i>2026 (planned)</i>	<i>2027 (planned)</i>
Cambodia, China and the Philippines convened national consultations on the care economy	The Philippines adopted an ordinance on valuing and investing in the care economy at the subnational level Indonesia and the Lao People's Democratic Republic convened national consultations on the care economy	Two member States (the Lao People's Democratic Republic and Timor-Leste) adopt policy measures on the care economy	Two member States strengthen their policy measures on the care economy	Two additional member States strengthen their policy measures on the care economy

Result 2: strengthened national capacity to develop inclusive population ageing policies
Programme performance in 2025 and target for 2027

- 19.101 The subprogramme's work contributed to 15 government population ageing focal points identifying gaps and priorities concerning formulating policies on population ageing, which met the planned target. In addition, three countries contributed to the ESCAP policy repository and database of good practices.
- 19.102 Progress towards the objective and the target for 2027 are presented in the performance measure below (see table 19.24).

Table 19.24

Performance measure

<i>2023 (actual)</i>	<i>2024 (actual)</i>	<i>2025 (actual)</i>	<i>2026 (planned)</i>	<i>2027 (planned)</i>
Bhutan, Malaysia and Thailand addressed population ageing in policy frameworks and action plans	20 per cent of ESCAP member States used an ESCAP online repository of good practices for drafting new population ageing policies, laws, programmes and guidelines	15 government population ageing focal points identified gaps and priorities concerning formulating policies on population ageing Three countries (Malaysia, Maldives and Türkiye) provided inputs to the policy repository and database of good practices	Member States initiate the development of inclusive policies by participating in ESCAP-led initiatives	Member States report on progress in the development of inclusive policies at the Asia-Pacific Intergovernmental Meeting on the Fifth Review and Appraisal of the Madrid International Plan of Action on Ageing

Result 3: member States identify country pathways for social protection policies that embed climate resilience**Proposed programme plan for 2027**

- 19.103 The subprogramme has built the capacity of eight member States to implement the Action Plan to Strengthen Regional Cooperation on Social Protection in Asia and the Pacific and conducted a comprehensive analysis of social protection systems across the region.

Lessons learned and planned change

- 19.104 The lesson for the subprogramme was that it needed to meet the demand from member States for support in strategically leveraging the potential of social protection to enhance people's resilience to climate change. In applying the lesson, the subprogramme will enhance the knowledge and capacity of countries to build stronger social protection systems and forge country pathways that facilitate the integration of policies relating to social protection and to climate change. The subprogramme will engage multisectoral partners and stakeholders to foster stronger awareness and collaboration in this area.
- 19.105 Expected progress towards the objective is presented in the performance measure below (see table 19.25).

Table 19.25

Performance measure

2023 (actual)	2024 (actual)	2025 (actual)	2026 (planned)	2027 (planned)
–	The importance of social protection for climate resilience was recognized at the eighth session of the Committee on Social Development	Cambodia referred to the importance of social protection for climate resilience in its nationally determined contribution	At least one additional member State refers to the importance of social protection for climate resilience in a national development strategy or sectoral plan	At least two member States outline recommendations to promote social protection policies that embed climate resilience in a country pathway document

Deliverables

- 19.106 Table 19.26 lists all deliverables of the subprogramme.

Table 19.26

Subprogramme 6: deliverables for the period 2025–2027, by category and subcategory

Category and subcategory	2025 planned	2025 actual	2026 planned ^a	2027 planned
A. Facilitation of the intergovernmental process and expert bodies				
Parliamentary documentation (number of documents)	3	3	4	3
Reports for:				
1. The Commission	1	1	1	1
2. The Committee on Social Development	–	–	3	–
3. The Asia-Pacific regional review of implementation of the Global Compact for Safe, Orderly and Regular Migration	2	2	–	–
4. The Asia-Pacific Intergovernmental Meeting on the Fifth Review and Appraisal of the Madrid International Plan of Action on Ageing	–	–	–	2

Category and subcategory	2025 planned	2025 actual	2026 planned ^a	2027 planned
Substantive services for meetings (number of three-hour meetings)	24	21	19	20
Meetings of:				
5. The Committee on Social Development	–	–	5	–
6. The United Nations Special Programme for the Economies of Central Asia Thematic Working Group on Gender and Sustainable Development Goals	2	–	2	–
7. The Working Group on the Asian and Pacific Decade of Persons with Disabilities, 2023–2032	4	4	4	4
8. The Asia-Pacific regional review of implementation of the Global Compact for Safe, Orderly and Regular Migration	6	6	–	–
9. The Asia-Pacific Intergovernmental Meeting on the Fifth Review and Appraisal of the Madrid International Plan of Action on Ageing	–	–	–	6
10. Expert groups on social inclusion	4	2	2 [4]	2
11. Expert groups on social policies	4	3	2 [4]	2
12. Expert groups on population	4	4	4	4
13. Expert group on the <i>Social Outlook for Asia and the Pacific</i>	–	2	–	2
B. Generation and transfer of knowledge				
Field and technical cooperation projects (number of projects)	3	13	4	4
14. On gender equality	–	3	1	1
15. On population and development	1	5	1	1
16. On disability inclusion	1	4	1	1
17. On social development	1	1	1	1
Publications (number of publications)	1	–	2	1
18. On disability inclusion	1	–	–	–
19. On gender equality	–	–	1	–
20. <i>Social Outlook for Asia and the Pacific</i>	–	–	1	–
21. <i>Asia-Pacific Report on Population Ageing</i>	–	–	–	1
Technical materials (number of materials)	11	12	6	7
22. On gender equality	1	1	– [1]	1
23. On disability inclusion	1	2	1	1
24. Policy brief on population and development	1	1	1	1
25. Working paper on population and development	1	1	1	1
26. Working papers on inequality	2	2	1 [2]	1
27. Datasheets on population	1	1	1	1
28. On social development	4	4	1 [4]	1
C. Substantive deliverables				
Consultation, advice and advocacy: advisory services for working groups on issues related to social development.				
Databases and substantive digital materials: online databases and resource facilities on social development for regional and global access.				
D. Communication deliverables				
Outreach programmes, special events and information materials: International Day of Older Persons.				

^a Reflects updated planned deliverables for 2026. Values in square brackets represent the number of planned deliverables reflected in A/80/6 (Sect. 19).

Subprogramme 7

Statistics

Objective

- 19.107 The objective, to which this subprogramme contributes, is to improve the availability, accessibility and use of quality, inclusive data and official statistics in support of sustainable development in Asia and the Pacific.

Strategy

- 19.108 To contribute to the objective, the subprogramme will:
- (a) Support statistical development in the region, regional cooperation and the formulation of regional positions to advance official statistics in line with existing commitments, including “Advancing official statistics for the 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development: a collective vision and framework for action by the Asia-Pacific statistical community”, the Declaration on Navigating Policy with Data to Leave No One Behind and the Ministerial Declaration on a Decade of Action for Inclusive and Resilient Civil Registration and Vital Statistics in Asia and the Pacific;
 - (b) Provide technical assistance, training and capacity-building support with the Statistical Institute for Asia and the Pacific:
 - (i) To enhance national statistical capacities to produce, disseminate and communicate statistical products and services, including but not limited to gender-sensitive, sex-disaggregated and disability-inclusive data and statistics, with an emphasis on those countries left further behind, such as countries in special situations;
 - (ii) To modernize national statistical systems and strengthen the capacity of national statistical offices to effectively use data generated across the national data ecosystems, including administrative data produced by other government ministries and agencies, and big data generated and held by private-sector entities, as appropriate;
 - (c) Provide statistical products and services, such as the *Asia and the Pacific Sustainable Development Goals Progress Report* and the Asia-Pacific Sustainable Development Goals Gateway, that make regional data and official statistics accessible to assess progress in the Asia-Pacific region towards achieving the Sustainable Development Goals;
 - (d) Develop and support the production of knowledge products in the form of research papers, working papers, statistics briefs and blogs to raise awareness of and share knowledge and experience relating to official statistics;
 - (e) Promote cooperation and facilitate consensus-building among member States, regional entities and other partners working in data and statistics through regional and country-specific initiatives. This includes, among other things, advancing the Declaration on Navigating Policy with Data to Leave No One Behind, data governance and mainstreaming a gender perspective in cooperation with member States and development partners, which will constitute the foundation for enhanced statistical capacity in Asia and the Pacific;
 - (f) Promote a whole-of-society approach to advancing the implementation of the Declaration on Navigating Policy with Data to Leave No One Behind and to build agile national statistical systems that are fit for the future.
- 19.109 The above-mentioned work is expected to contribute to:
- (a) Improved availability, accessibility and use of quality data and official statistics in support of sustainable development in Asia and the Pacific through country-led initiatives;
 - (b) Increased capacity of national statistical systems to review progress in the implementation of the 2030 Agenda;

- (c) Increased reliance on statistical data for evidence-based decision-making across the Asia-Pacific region.

Programme performance in 2025

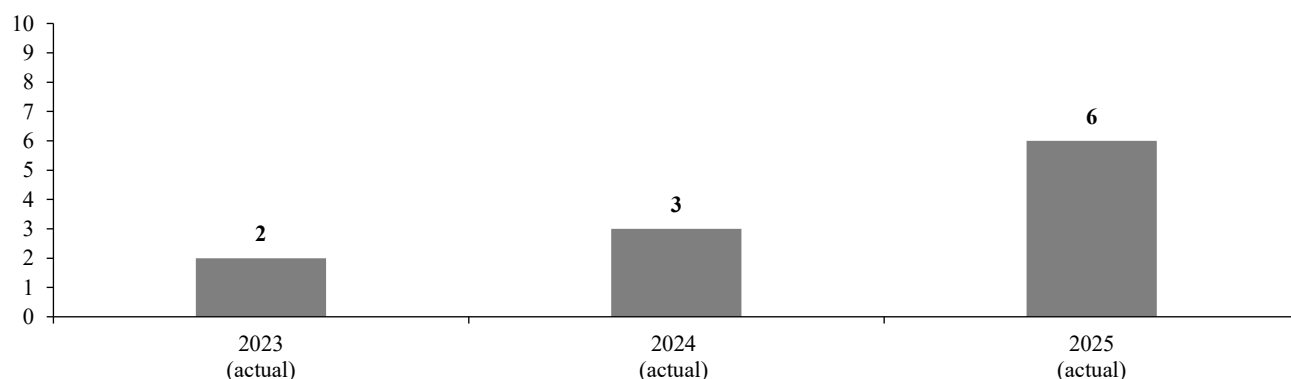
Leveraging data to drive progress in civil registration

19.110 The subprogramme has adopted an integrated approach to strengthening civil registration and vital statistics systems across the region by combining an intergovernmental process with joint analysis and targeted support for capacity-building in countries. The decade-long regional action framework on civil and vital registration has fostered collaboration among member States and provided a platform for sharing good practices. In 2025, the subprogramme serviced the Third Ministerial Conference on Civil Registration and Vital Statistics in Asia and the Pacific, which reflected growing political commitment and showcased the power of partnerships. It brought together member States, associate members, United Nations entities and civil society organizations to take concrete steps towards building more inclusive and resilient civil registration and vital statistics systems. Youth played a prominent role at the event, sharing their experiences and advocating for the importance of universal birth registration with senior policymakers. In addition, the subprogramme has strengthened national capacities in using demographic analysis to drive significant progress in birth registration in Asia and the Pacific. A key strategy of the subprogramme has been the use of civil registration and vital statistics inequality assessments, which identify disparities in registration by gender, geography and characteristics of parents and children. The assessments are essential for transforming the vision of universal civil registration and vital statistics into a reality and help to ensure that all individuals can access their rights and essential services.

19.111 Progress towards the objective is presented in the performance measure below (see figure 19.VI).

Figure 19.VI

Performance measure: number of member States with completed civil registration and vital statistics inequality assessments (cumulative)



Planned results for 2027

Result 1: improved data governance by national statistical offices across Asia and the Pacific

Programme performance in 2025 and target for 2027

- 19.112 The subprogramme's work contributed to five member States taking steps to address data governance challenges and contribute to a compendium of country data governance practices, which met the planned target.
- 19.113 Progress towards the objective and the target for 2027 are presented in the performance measure below (see table 19.27).

Table 19.27
Performance measure

2023 (actual)	2024 (actual)	2025 (actual)	2026 (planned)	2027 (planned)
ESCAP, at its seventy-ninth session, endorsed the revised focus of the Committee on Statistics	20 member States contributed to a compendium of country data governance practices, enabling member States to share experiences to address data governance challenges	Five member States (Bhutan, Georgia, Kazakhstan, Maldives and Mongolia) took steps to address data governance challenges and contributed to a compendium of country data governance practices	Six member States take steps to address data governance challenges and contribute to a compendium of country data governance practices	Eight member States take steps to address data governance challenges and contribute to a compendium of country data governance practices

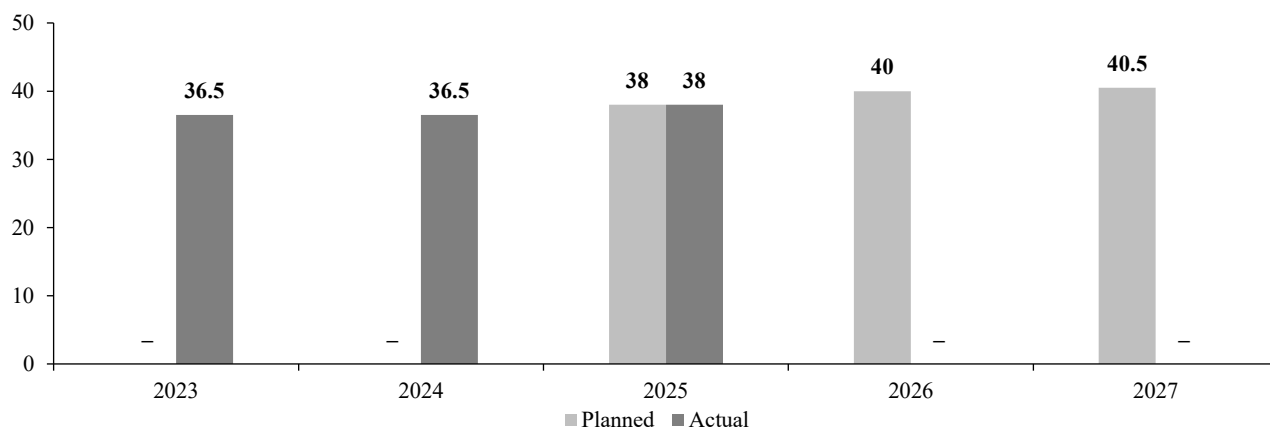
Result 2: establishment of national Sustainable Development Goal platforms to monitor progress towards the 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development in Asia and the Pacific

Programme performance in 2025 and target for 2027

- 19.114 The subprogramme's work contributed to 38 per cent of Asia and the Pacific countries operating an official and dedicated online portal which can be used for reporting Sustainable Development Goal progress, which met the planned target.
- 19.115 Progress towards the objective and the target for 2027 are presented in the performance measure below (see figure 19.VII).

Figure 19.VII

Performance measure: percentage of Asia-Pacific countries with an official country-operated, dedicated online portal for reporting Sustainable Development Goals progress



Result 3: strengthened national statistical systems through a whole-of-society approach

Proposed programme plan for 2027

- 19.116 The Bureau of the ESCAP Committee on Statistics established a data and statistics horizon team, which will advance the Declaration on Navigating Policy with Data to Leave No One Behind by supporting national statistical offices to embed a whole-of-society approach across the statistical production process.

Lessons learned and planned change

- 19.117 A key lesson for the subprogramme was the need to foster a multi-stakeholder approach to enable national statistical systems to meet the growing demands for real-time, granular data to monitor global commitments and to ensure that no one is left behind. In applying the lesson, the subprogramme is promoting a whole-of-society approach to build more flexible and responsive statistical systems. This includes supporting statistical offices to work with a broad range of stakeholders to identify priority issues and ensure that data collection, analysis and use reflect the needs and perspectives of all sectors of society.
- 19.118 Expected progress towards the objective is presented in the performance measure below (see table 19.28).

Table 19.28

Performance measure

2023 (actual)	2024 (actual)	2025 (actual)	2026 (planned)	2027 (planned)
–	Member States committed to advance a whole-of-society approach to building agile statistical systems	The Bureau of the ESCAP Committee on Statistics decided to establish a data and statistics horizon team to develop a whole-of-society approach to building agile statistical systems	Two Asia-Pacific countries adopt a whole-of-society approach to building agile statistical systems	Three Asia-Pacific countries adopt a whole-of-society approach to building agile statistical systems

Deliverables

- 19.119 Table 19.29 lists all deliverables of the subprogramme.

Table 19.29

Subprogramme 7: deliverables for the period 2025–2027, by category and subcategory

Category and subcategory	2025 planned	2025 actual	2026 planned ^a	2027 planned
A. Facilitation of the intergovernmental process and expert bodies				
Parliamentary documentation (number of documents)	2	3	2	1
Reports for:				
1. The Commission	1	1	1	1
2. The Committee on Statistics	–	–	1	–
3. The Ministerial Conference on Civil Registration and Vital Statistics in Asia and the Pacific	1	2	–	–
Substantive services for meetings (number of three-hour meetings)	22	19	17	12
Meetings of:				
4. The Committee on Statistics	–	–	5	–
5. The Governing Council of the Statistical Institute for Asia and the Pacific	3	3	3	3
6. The Ministerial Conference on Civil Registration and Vital Statistics in Asia and the Pacific	6	6	–	–
7. Expert groups on the use of non-traditional and complementary data sources in official statistics	2	2	2	2
8. The Regional Steering Group for Civil Registration and Vital Statistics in Asia and the Pacific	6	5	4 [6]	4
9. Expert groups on strengthening national statistical systems for enhanced quality and trust in official statistics	3	3	3	3

Category and subcategory	2025 planned	2025 actual	2026 planned ^a	2027 planned
10. The technical working group on disaster-related statistics in Asia and the Pacific	2	–	–	–
B. Generation and transfer of knowledge				
Field and technical cooperation projects (number of projects)	4	6	3	4
11. On statistics	4	6	3	4
Seminars, workshops and training events (number of days)	10	186	125	121
12. On statistics	8	15	10	10
13. On gender equality-related statistics and issues	2	3	–	1
14. On official statistics and management issues	–	32	15	15
15. On population statistics	–	24	25	25
16. On economic statistics	–	33	25	20
17. On environment and disaster statistics	–	51	25	25
18. On methodology and statistical process	–	28	25	25
Publications (number of publications)	1	1	1	1
19. <i>Asia and the Pacific SDG Progress Report</i>	1	1	1	1
Technical materials (number of materials)	2	2	2	2
20. On a variety of official statistics topics	2	2	2	2
C. Substantive deliverables				
Consultation, advice and advocacy: advisory support for subregional networks on official social, economic and environmental statistics; side event on statistics at the Asia-Pacific Forum on Sustainable Development.				
Databases and substantive digital materials: ESCAP statistical database accessible at the regional and global levels.				

^a Reflects updated planned deliverables for 2026. Values in square brackets represent the number of planned deliverables reflected in A/80/6 (Sect. 19).

Subprogramme 8 Subregional activities for development

Component 1 Subregional activities for development in the Pacific

Objective

- 19.120 The objective, to which component 1 of the subprogramme contributes, is to strengthen regional cooperation and integration for sustainable development, in line with the subregional priorities of the Pacific, which include building resilience against natural hazards and climate change to reduce vulnerabilities and to improve socioeconomic conditions.

Strategy

- 19.121 To contribute to the objective, the component will be guided by the Antigua and Barbuda Agenda for Small Island Developing States and the Doha Programme of Action for the Least Developed Countries. It will:
- (a) Support the advancement of the 2050 Strategy for the Blue Pacific Continent, containing the streamlined Pacific Road Map for Sustainable Development, and serve as the focal point for the Commission's engagement with the resident coordinator system and United Nations country teams, including through substantive assistance in the implementation of the United Nations Sustainable Development Cooperation Frameworks, in particular with regard to the

transboundary dimensions of sustainable development, and assist country-level programming by providing subregional perspectives and access to regional networks and facilitating South-South and triangular cooperation;

- (b) Organize annual meetings and facilitate dialogues on sustainable development, including a subregional forum on sustainable development, among government officials, civil society, experts and other stakeholders, and on the sharing of information on subregional implementation efforts;
 - (c) Provide technical assistance and advisory services with regard to addressing the socioeconomic challenges of the subregion and devising appropriate recovery responses through national frameworks for Sustainable Development Goal financing, national planning, sector policies and strategies and regional cooperation on transboundary issues, in line with the outcomes of relevant assessments;
 - (d) Provide technical assistance to member States and create knowledge-exchange opportunities between member States and civil society to develop nationally appropriate indicator frameworks and promote women's economic empowerment, social protection and disability policies, in cooperation with subprogramme 6;
 - (e) Provide subregional and in-country capacity development support in identifying and valuing ecosystem goods and services for the sustainable management of resources, in cooperation with subprogrammes 4 and 7;
 - (f) Promote coordination with and collaboration among subregional intergovernmental organizations and member States for an effective representation of subregional perspectives at regional and global consultations, and provide implementation support for the Commission's subprogrammes relating to the subregion's priorities;
 - (g) Strengthen coordination with the Pacific Islands Forum Secretariat and other agencies of the Council of Regional Organizations of the Pacific to deliver the 2050 Strategy for the Blue Pacific Continent in line with the 2030 Agenda.
- 19.122 The above-mentioned work will help to support member States in their progress towards the achievement of Sustainable Development Goals 5, 10, 13 to 15 and 17, and is expected to result in:
- (a) Improved data availability for evidence-based policymaking on climate-resilient, sustainable development;
 - (b) Strengthened capacity of member States to implement and monitor the 2030 Agenda and subregional agendas while ensuring that no one is left behind and that development activities address socioeconomic conditions and reach people in vulnerable situations;
 - (c) Stronger subregional cooperation to address transboundary issues;
 - (d) Advanced inclusive economic development in the Pacific subregion.

Programme performance in 2025

Strengthened capacity for integration of economic valuation of ecosystem goods and services into policy and planning by Pacific Governments

- 19.123 The 2050 Strategy for the Blue Pacific Continent, outlining key priorities of the Pacific and endorsed by the Pacific leaders in 2022, highlights valuing the Pacific region's ecosystem goods and services as one of the key aspects of the sustainable management of resources. The component, in collaboration with the Pacific Islands Forum Secretariat and the secretariat of the Pacific Regional Environmental Programme, and with support from the regular programme of technical cooperation, developed a user-friendly online guide to support Pacific Governments in utilizing the economic valuation of ecosystem goods and services for their policy decision-making, where appropriate. The mapping of existing assessments of the economic value of ecosystem goods and services in the

Pacific was conducted and reviewed by two expert group meetings. A regional workshop on ecosystem valuation attended by Pacific government officials validated the utility of the online guide and served as a forum for peer-to-peer learning, including experiences from Asia.

19.124 Progress towards the objective is presented in the performance measure below (see table 19.30).

Table 19.30
Performance measure

2023 (actual)	2024 (actual)	2025 (actual)
—	The valuation of ecosystem goods and services for informed decision-making was considered by Pacific economic officials as a potential indicator for diversifying economic sustainability and inclusivity within and across sectors and was reflected in the draft of the Pacific Road Map for Economic Development	Capacities of Pacific member States in understanding and applying ecosystem valuation through the ESCAP online tool were strengthened, enabling more informed policy and planning decisions for sustainable resource management and development

Planned results for 2027

Result 1: pathways to mainstream the Antigua and Barbuda Agenda for Small Island Developing States into national development strategies

Programme performance in 2025 and target for 2027

- 19.125 The component's work contributed to three member States (Micronesia (Federated States of), Solomon Islands and Tonga) identifying pathways to mainstream the Antigua and Barbuda Agenda for Small Island Developing States, which met the planned target.
- 19.126 Progress towards the objective and the target for 2027 are presented in the performance measure below (see table 19.31).

Table 19.31
Performance measure

2023 (actual)	2024 (actual)	2025 (actual)	2026 (planned)	2027 (planned)
Pacific members and associate members agreed on subregional challenges and priorities	Pacific members' and associate members' priorities were reflected in the outcome document of the Fourth International Conference on Small Island Developing States	Three member States (Micronesia (Federated States of), Solomon Islands and Tonga) identified pathways to mainstream the Antigua and Barbuda Agenda for Small Island Developing States	Two additional countries identify pathways to mainstream the Antigua and Barbuda Agenda for Small Island Developing States	Two additional countries identify pathways to mainstream the Antigua and Barbuda Agenda for Small Island Developing States

Result 2: increased effectiveness in the production and use of core indicators for national, regional and global reporting

Programme performance in 2025 and target for 2027

- 19.127 The component's work contributed to three member States (Fiji, Micronesia (Federated States of) and Tonga) aligning and enhancing monitoring of national, regional and global agendas, which met the planned target.
- 19.128 Progress towards the objective and the target for 2027 are presented in the performance measure below (see table 19.32).

Table 19.32
Performance measure

2023 (actual)	2024 (actual)	2025 (actual)	2026 (planned)	2027 (planned)
Pacific member States formulated a framework for aligning agendas to simplify reporting	Experts (from Kiribati and Tonga) discussed solutions to align Pacific country reporting against global, regional and national frameworks	Three member States (Fiji, Micronesia (Federated States of) and Tonga) align and enhance monitoring of national, regional and global agendas	At least three additional member States align and enhance monitoring of national, regional and global agendas	At least three additional member States align and/or enhance monitoring of national, regional and global agendas

Result 3: amplify the Pacific's voice to advance a more tailored United Nations multidimensional vulnerability index

Proposed programme plan for 2027

- 19.129 Pacific small island developing States face chronic debt stress and strongly advocated for the adoption of the United Nations multidimensional vulnerability index as a tool to capture the complex structural vulnerabilities of small island developing States. By moving beyond purely economic measures, the multidimensional vulnerability index also incorporates social and environmental dimensions, offering the potential to improve access to concessional finance and development support for the Pacific. The component supported Pacific small island developing States in assessing the relevance of the multidimensional vulnerability index and identifying ways to refine it to better capture their specific vulnerability challenges.

Lessons learned and planned change

- 19.130 The lesson for the component was that stronger collaboration among Pacific small island developing States is needed to link subregional experiences with global multidimensional vulnerability index initiatives. In applying the lesson, the component will support Pacific leaders to advocate for the formation of common positions to amplify the voices of Pacific small island developing States at the regional and global levels. It plans to strengthen the integration of Pacific insights into position briefs and prepare these briefs for high-level meetings to ensure that the index reflects small island developing States' evolving vulnerabilities.
- 19.131 Expected progress towards the objective is presented in the performance measure below (see table 19.33).

Table 19.33
Performance measure

2023 (actual)	2024 (actual)	2025 (actual)	2026 (planned)	2027 (planned)
–	–	Pacific leaders called for the operationalization of the multidimensional vulnerability index to unlock fairer access to climate finance	Pacific leaders advocate to capture the Pacific specificities in the multidimensional vulnerability index to shape access to development finance	Discussions on the multidimensional vulnerability index at the regional and global levels reflect the positions of Pacific small island developing States and Pacific intergovernmental agencies

Deliverables

19.132 Table 19.34 lists all deliverables of the component.

Table 19.34
Component 1: deliverables for the period 2025–2027, by category and subcategory

Category and subcategory	2025 planned	2025 actual	2026 planned	2027 planned
A. Facilitation of the intergovernmental process and expert bodies				
Parliamentary documentation (number of documents)	1	1	–	–
1. Report for the Commission	1	1	–	–
Substantive services for meetings (number of three-hour meetings)	8	8	8	8
Meetings of:				
2. Expert groups on policy and programme options to address emerging sustainable development issues in the Pacific	4	4	4	4
3. The Pacific Forum on Sustainable Development	4	4	4	4
B. Generation and transfer of knowledge				
Field and technical cooperation projects (number of projects)	2	2	2	2
4. On institutional programmatic priorities of ESCAP in the Pacific	1	1	1	1
5. On economic and social development	1	1	1	1
Seminars, workshops and training events (number of days)	2	1	2	2
6. On sustainable development and building resilience in the Pacific	2	1	2	2
Technical materials (number of materials)	1	–	1	1
7. On regional cooperation and sustainable development in the Pacific	1	–	1	1
C. Substantive deliverables				
Consultation, advice and advocacy: expert advice to member States in the subregion to strengthen regional cooperation and integration for sustainable development and to build resilience against natural hazards and climate change to reduce vulnerabilities and improve socioeconomic conditions.				

Component 2

Subregional activities for development in East and North-East Asia

Objective

- 19.133 The objective, to which component 2 of the subprogramme contributes, is to strengthen regional cooperation for sustainable development, in line with the subregional priorities of East and North-East Asia, which includes sustainable connectivity, environmental sustainability and innovation for inclusive and resilient societies.

Strategy

- 19.134 To contribute to the objective, the component will:
- (a) Facilitate multisectoral dialogues and promote knowledge-sharing among member States on sustainable development, environmental sustainability, trade, transport, energy and ICT connectivity, as well as on emerging technologies and their deployment in priority sectors, through regional and subregional platforms, including the North-East Asian Subregional Programme for Environmental Cooperation, the North-East Asia Clean Air Partnership and the North-East Asia Regional Power Interconnection and Cooperation Forum;
 - (b) Identify and promote innovative approaches to facilitate cross-border connectivity, where applicable, such as contactless cross-border trade and transport solutions, and cross-border data exchanges between railway and customs authorities, with a particular focus on Mongolia as the only landlocked developing country in East and North-East Asia;
 - (c) Develop knowledge products and foster peer-to-peer exchanges on inclusive science, technology and innovation policies and programmes with a focus on people in vulnerable situations, including on ageing societies, disaster resilience, disability inclusion and gender equality in the technology industry;
 - (d) Support the implementation of a road map for sustainable power connectivity and promote intergovernmental processes for sustainable connectivity, environmental sustainability and innovation in East and North-East Asia, as relevant;
 - (e) Build the capacity of member States on the above-mentioned focus areas and promote coordination with and collaboration among subregional intergovernmental organizations and member States for an effective representation of subregional perspectives at regional and global consultations, as appropriate;
 - (f) Provide implementation support for the Commission's subprogrammes relating to the subregion's priorities and serve as the focal point for the Commission's engagement with the resident coordinator system and United Nations country teams, including through substantive assistance with regard to preparing common country assessments and United Nations Sustainable Development Cooperation Frameworks, in particular with regard to the transboundary dimensions of sustainable development, and assist country-level programming by providing subregional perspectives and access to regional networks and facilitating South-South and triangular cooperation.
- 19.135 These workstreams will help member States to make progress towards the achievement of Sustainable Development Goals 3, 5, 7, 9 to 11, 13 to 15 and 17.
- 19.136 The above-mentioned work is expected to result in:
- (a) Policy coherence and coordination of connectivity initiatives among member States, for example, with regard to trade and transport facilitation;
 - (b) Coordinated actions among stakeholders and Governments to counter common environmental challenges, including air pollution, and to promote low greenhouse gas emissions;

- (c) Improved use of science, technology and innovation in building inclusive and resilient societies in the subregion, including resilience to natural hazards;
- (d) More effective formulation and implementation of policies and strategies consistent with the 2030 Agenda, including through the North-East Asia Multi-stakeholder Forums on the Sustainable Development Goals;
- (e) Enhanced collaboration among Governments, the United Nations, subregional organizations and other stakeholders to address priority challenges in the subregion, as appropriate.

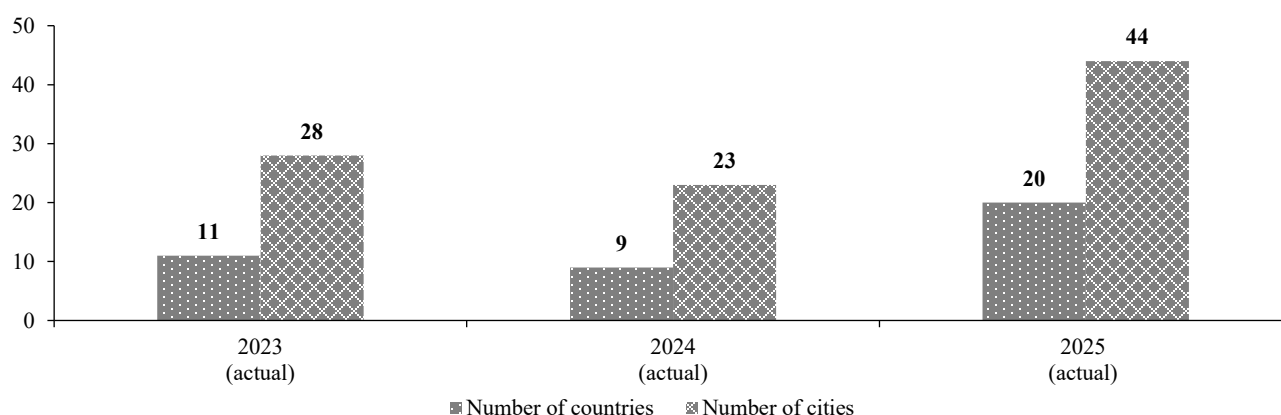
Programme performance in 2025

Enhanced knowledge-sharing to advance local climate action

- 19.137 Reducing emissions in East and North-East Asia by the middle of the twenty-first century requires accelerated climate action at the local level. The component promoted local climate action by facilitating the exchange of knowledge, experiences and good practices among cities. At the annual International Forum on Low Carbon Cities, the component brings together national and city-level stakeholders to exchange policy practices and discuss innovations and technologies for sustainable urban solutions in the context of changing demographics and lifestyles. To strengthen local climate action, the component also issued a booklet on subregional cooperation and policy alignment for reducing urban greenhouse gas emissions through city networks in the subregion. It has undertaken efforts to increase the reach of the Forum and elevate its impact from an initial national effort to become a region-wide forum.
- 19.138 Progress towards the objective is presented in the performance measure below (see figure 19.VIII).

Figure 19.VIII

Performance measure: number of countries and cities in Asia and the Pacific from which the participants at the International Forum on Low Carbon Cities originated (annual)



Planned results for 2027

Result 1: efficient management of cross-border railway transport and transit

Programme performance in 2025 and target for 2027

- 19.139 The component's work contributed to customs and railway officials in Mongolia implementing a workplan for the interconnection of railway and customs information systems, which met the planned target of national officials increasingly adopting electronic information exchange for more efficient cross-border railway transport and transit in North-East Asia.
- 19.140 Progress towards the objective and the target for 2027 are presented in the performance measure below (see table 19.35).

Table 19.35
Performance measure

2023 (actual)	2024 (actual)	2025 (actual)	2026 (planned)	2027 (planned)
The Russian Federation acceded to the Framework Agreement on Facilitation of Cross-border Paperless Trade in Asia and the Pacific	Railway and customs authorities in Mongolia built capacity on cross-border electronic information exchange to strengthen the country's readiness to undertake paperless transit and transport operations	Customs and railway officials in Mongolia implemented a workplan for the interconnection of railway and customs information systems	Member States adopt a plan for electronic information exchange for more efficient cross-border railway transport and transit in North-East Asia	Member States further implement initiatives for electronic information exchange for more efficient cross-border railway transport and transit in North-East Asia
Member States adopted guiding principles on electronic information exchange among railways and control authorities				

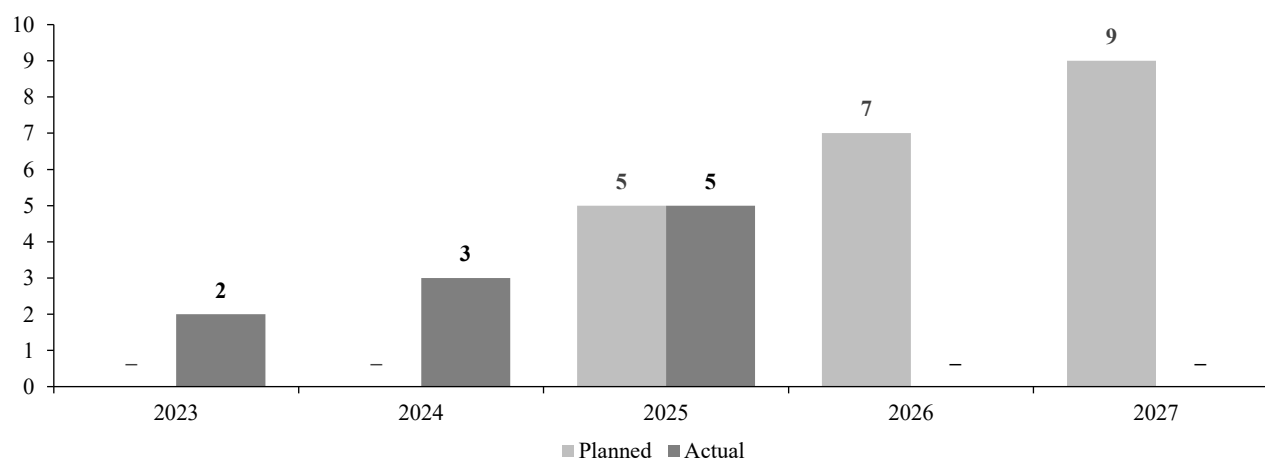
Result 2: strengthened cross-border collaboration on addressing desertification and land degradation in East and North-East Asia

Programme performance in 2025 and target for 2027

- 19.141 The component's work contributed to two additional cross-border activities undertaken by member States on desertification and land degradation under the North-East Asian Subregional Programme for Environmental Cooperation, which met the cumulative planned target.
- 19.142 Progress towards the objective and the target for 2027 are presented in the performance measure below (see figure 19.IX).

Figure 19.IX

Performance measure: number of cross-border activities undertaken by member States on desertification and land degradation under the North-East Asian Subregional Programme for Environmental Cooperation (cumulative)



Result 3: strengthened collaboration on marine protected areas in North-East Asia

Proposed programme plan for 2027

- 19.143 Marine protected areas play a vital role in conserving biodiversity, sustaining fisheries and safeguarding ecosystems that are essential for community well-being and sustainable development in East and North-East Asia. In support of the North-East Asian Subregional Programme for Environmental Cooperation, the component established a subregional marine protected areas network to promote information-sharing, joint assessments and monitoring, as well as partnerships with global and regional initiatives.

Lessons learned and planned change

- 19.144 The lesson for the component was that effective regional cooperation requires strong local engagement, consistent knowledge exchange and active cross-sectoral partnerships. In applying the lesson, the component will strengthen its role as a subregional platform by deepening cross-sectoral collaboration, examining the interlinkages between climate and marine protected areas, organizing peer-learning seminars and workshops and aligning its work more closely with global sustainability frameworks.

- 19.145 Expected progress towards the objective is presented in the performance measure below (see table 19.36).

Table 19.36

Performance measure

2023 (actual)	2024 (actual)	2025 (actual)	2026 (planned)	2027 (planned)
Member States supported studies on ocean-based climate actions for marine protected areas in China and the Republic of Korea	Member States acknowledged the progress achieved and noted the expansion of partnerships aimed at creating a marine protected areas network across East Asia	Member States adopted a strategic plan for the period 2026–2030 aimed at further enhancing partnerships through knowledge exchange	Member States strengthen their partnerships and build technical capacity on marine protected areas	Member States enhance collaboration with regional platforms on marine protected areas beyond North-East Asia

Deliverables

- 19.146 Table 19.37 lists all deliverables of the component.

Table 19.37

Component 2: deliverables for the period 2025–2027, by category and subcategory

Category and subcategory	2025 planned	2025 actual	2026 planned ^a	2027 planned
A. Facilitation of the intergovernmental process and expert bodies				
Parliamentary documentation (number of documents)	1	1	–	–
1. Report for the Commission	1	1	–	–
Substantive services for meetings (number of three-hour meetings)	9	7	7	7
Meetings of:				
2. Expert groups on policy and programme options to address emerging economic and social development issues in East and North-East Asia	2	–	– [2]	–
3. Senior officials of the North-East Asian Subregional Programme for Environmental Cooperation	3	3	3	3

Category and subcategory	2025 planned	2025 actual	2026 planned ^a	2027 planned
4. The North-East Asian Multi-stakeholder Forum on the Sustainable Development Goals	4	4	4	4
B. Generation and transfer of knowledge				
Field and technical cooperation projects (number of projects)	4	5	4	4
5. On institutional programmatic priorities of ESCAP in East and North-East Asia	3	4	3	3
6. North-East Asian Subregional Programme for Environmental Cooperation	1	1	1	1
Seminars, workshops and training events (number of days)	2	3	2	2
7. On transport and energy connectivity	1	1	1	1
8. On science, technology and innovation for low-carbon and low-emissions and resilient cities and on North-East Asian Subregional Programme for Environmental Cooperation-related events	1	2	1	1
Publications (number of publications)	–	–	–	–
9. On emerging sustainable development issues in North-East Asia	–	–	– [1]	–
Technical materials (number of materials)	1	1	1	1
10. On technology and social issues	1	1	–	–
11. On emerging sustainable development issues in North-East Asia	–	–	1	1
C. Substantive deliverables				
Consultation, advice and advocacy: expert advice to member States of the subregion on sustainable connectivity, environmental sustainability and innovation for inclusive and resilient societies; side events at the Commission session.				
D. Communication deliverables				
Outreach programmes, special events and information materials: newsletters, infographics and side activities on major events on sustainable connectivity, environmental sustainability and innovation for inclusive and resilient societies.				

^a Reflects updated planned deliverables for 2026. Values in square brackets represent the number of planned deliverables reflected in [A/80/6 \(Sect. 19\)](#).

Component 3 Subregional activities for development in North and Central Asia

Objective

- 19.147 The objective, to which component 3 of the subprogramme contributes, is to strengthen regional cooperation and integration for sustainable development, in line with the subregional priorities of North and Central Asia, including sustainable connectivity, economic transformation, and social inclusion and resilience, and through follow-up and review of the 2030 Agenda.

Strategy

- 19.148 To contribute to the objective, the component will:
- Provide secretariat support to and coordinate the thematic working groups of the United Nations Special Programme for the Economies of Central Asia to ensure that priorities emanating from the decisions and recommendations of the Governing Council and the Economic Forums of the Special Programme regarding trade facilitation, innovation and technology, transport, energy and digital connectivity, innovative financing and investment tools, environmental sustainability and gender equality are incorporated into their workplans;
 - Coordinate high-level dialogues and working meetings to support landlocked developing countries in the implementation of their priorities;

- (c) Support member States in the implementation of the 2030 Agenda by providing policy advice and technical assistance on subregional connectivity, helping member States to make progress towards achieving Sustainable Development Goals 7, 9 and 17;
- (d) Organize annual meetings and facilitate dialogues on sustainable development, including a subregional forum on sustainable development, among government officials, civil society, experts and other stakeholders, and on the exchange of information on the subregional achievement of the Sustainable Development Goals, helping member States to review the progress;
- (e) Support voluntary national review processes at the request of member States, including the voluntary national review twinning programme, and build capacity for sustainable and resilient development;
- (f) Cooperate with subregional intergovernmental organizations and institutions such as the Shanghai Cooperation Organization, the Economic Cooperation Organization, the Eurasian Economic Commission and the Eurasian Development Bank for an effective implementation of subregional priorities;
- (g) Provide implementation support for the Commission's subprogrammes relating to the subregion's priorities and serve as the focal point for the Commission's engagement with the resident coordinator system and United Nations country teams, including through substantive assistance in preparing common country assessments and United Nations Sustainable Development Cooperation Frameworks, in particular with regard to the transboundary dimensions of sustainable development, and assist country-level programming by providing subregional perspectives and access to regional networks and facilitating South-South and triangular cooperation.

19.149 The above-mentioned work is expected to result in:

- (a) Enhanced application by member States of, evidence-based solutions for, and strengthened subregional cooperation on, programmes to improve trade and transport facilitation as well as energy and digital connectivity;
- (b) The adoption of policy options for economic transformation in the subregion;
- (c) Increased knowledge-sharing in cooperation with intergovernmental organizations and bodies.

Programme performance in 2025

Member States in North and Central Asia develop recommendations to strengthen trade

19.150 Trade activities of countries in North and Central Asia have surged in recent years and contributed significantly to robust economic growth. With seven of the nine countries of the North and Central Asia subregion being landlocked developing countries, the development of trade faces several structural and institutional challenges, including export concentration in commodities, inefficient trade procedures and insufficient implementation of regional cooperation agreements. To strengthen the priorities related to trade, trade facilitation and regional integration of the Awaza Programme of Action for Landlocked Developing Countries for the Decade 2024–2034, the component organized an expert group meeting with representatives of member States to develop recommendations on strengthening the subregion's trade by developing mutually complementary trade digitalization and environmentally sustainable trade facilitation measures, as well as promoting regional trade initiatives in North and Central Asia.

19.151 Progress towards the objective is presented in the performance measure below (see table 19.38).

Table 19.38

Performance measure

2023 (actual)	2024 (actual)	2025 (actual)
Member States engaged in a dialogue with the International Think Tank for Landlocked Developing Countries on progress and challenges related to implementing the Vienna Programme of Action for Landlocked Developing Countries for the Decade 2014–2024	Armenia, Azerbaijan, Kyrgyzstan and Tajikistan reported progress towards reaching the targets of the Vienna Programme of Action	Policymakers from landlocked developing countries in the subregion developed recommendations on strengthening the subregion's trade

Planned results for 2027
Result 1: strengthened cooperation instruments of the United Nations Special Programme for the Economies of Central Asia
Programme performance in 2025 and target for 2027

- 19.152 The component's work contributed to the operationalization of the multi-partner trust fund for the United Nations Special Programme for the Economies of Central Asia and two countries participating in the Special Programme (Azerbaijan and Uzbekistan) contributing to the fund, which met the planned target of the financial stability of the United Nations Special Programme for the Economies of Central Asia to implement activities being enhanced.
- 19.153 Progress towards the objective and the target for 2027 are presented in the performance measure below (see table 19.39).

Table 19.39

Performance measure

2023 (actual)	2024 (actual)	2025 (actual)	2026 (planned)	2027 (planned)
Countries participating in the United Nations Special Programme for the Economies of Central Asia established a Special Programme fund in the United Nations multi-partner trust fund format	Countries participating in the United Nations Special Programme for the Economies of Central Asia reiterated their commitment to the establishment of the Special Programme's multi-partner trust fund and its steering committee for the effective management and coordination of all strategic, operational, technical and management aspects of the fund	Two countries participating in the United Nations Special Programme for the Economies of Central Asia contributed to the multi-partner trust fund	Countries participating in the United Nations Special Programme for the Economies of Central Asia develop joint projects for the multi-partner trust fund	Projects under the multi-partner trust fund for the United Nations Special Programme for the Economies of Central Asia are under implementation, with participating countries demonstrating strengthened institutional capacity

Result 2: member States advance digital transformation policies

Programme performance in 2025 and target for 2027

- 19.154 The component's work contributed to the exchange of best practices among 11 countries from North and Central Asia and South-East Asia in advancing digital transformation across key economic sectors, including trade, e-commerce, transport connectivity and infrastructure, supply chains and security of digital systems and data, and highlight digital initiatives that contribute to the sustainable development of their economies, which met the planned target.
- 19.155 Progress towards the objective and the target for 2027 are presented in the performance measure below (see table 19.40).

Table 19.40
Performance measure

2023 (actual)	2024 (actual)	2025 (actual)	2026 (planned)	2027 (planned)
–	Eurasian Economic Commission and ASEAN implemented a joint project to strengthen subregional cooperation on digital transformation for economic and sustainable development	11 countries from North and Central Asia and South-East Asia exchanged best practices in advancing digital transformation across key economic sectors and highlighted digital initiatives that contributed to the sustainable development of their economies	Member States formulate policies and strategies in relation to digital transformation for sustainable development	Member States establish at least three regional digital initiatives on cross-border digital identity, trade and customs integration

Result 3: strengthened subregional cooperation on power grid modernization and renewable energy integration in North and Central Asia

Proposed programme plan for 2027

- 19.156 Electricity grids are critical for integrating renewable energy, improving efficiency and maintaining system stability. Their modernization and expansions provide opportunities for achieving just and inclusive energy transitions. The component has facilitated the conduct of pilot studies to create a shared understanding of challenges related to renewable energy integration, infrastructure constraints and investment planning.

Lessons learned and planned change

- 19.157 The lesson for the component was that advancing grid modernization and connectivity requires a combination of context-specific technical analysis validated through stakeholder consultations, and strengthened coordination among Governments, development partners and industry stakeholders. In applying this lesson, the component will provide subregional-specific inputs to the development of the grid assessment framework and facilitate national consultations to validate findings and refine country-specific recommendations, while promoting data-sharing and harmonizing analytical methodologies to strengthen the evidence base. By linking technical findings to policy dialogue, the component will also contribute to advancing regional commitments under the 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development, ensuring that subregional cooperation supports both national priorities and global sustainability goals.

19.158 Expected progress towards the objective is presented in the performance measure below (see table 19.41).

Table 19.41

Performance measure

2023 (actual)	2024 (actual)	2025 (actual)	2026 (planned)	2027 (planned)
–	–	Increasingly in-depth and substantive subregional structured dialogues on energy connectivity in North and Central Asia	Perspectives of the subregion are reflected in the development of the grid assessment framework	Analytical and technical knowledge of government officials and stakeholders to assess national power grids is strengthened

Deliverables

19.159 Table 19.42 lists all deliverables of the component.

Table 19.42

Component 3: deliverables for the period 2025–2027, by category and subcategory

Category and subcategory	2025 planned	2025 actual	2026 planned ^a	2027 planned
A. Facilitation of the intergovernmental process and expert bodies				
Parliamentary documentation (number of documents)	1	1	–	–
1. Report for the Commission	1	1	–	–
Substantive services for meetings (number of three-hour meetings)	12	8	12	12
Meetings of:				
2. The Governing Council of the United Nations Special Programme for the Economies of Central Asia	1	–	1	1
3. The Economic Forum of the United Nations Special Programme for the Economies of Central Asia	3	–	3	3
4. Expert groups on policy and programme options to address emerging economic and social development issues in North and Central Asia	4	4	4	4
5. The subregional forum on the Sustainable Development Goals in North and Central Asia	4	4	4	4
B. Generation and transfer of knowledge				
Technical materials (number of materials)	1	1	–	–
6. On regional cooperation and integration for the landlocked and transit developing countries	1	1	– [1]	–
C. Substantive deliverables				
Consultation, advice and advocacy: advocacy with member States of the United Nations Special Programme for the Economies of Central Asia on regional and subregional priority issues; side events for member States and regional organizations at the annual session of the Commission.				

^a Reflects updated planned deliverables for 2026. Values in square brackets represent the number of planned deliverables reflected in A/80/6 (Sect. 19).

Component 4

Subregional activities for development in South and South-West Asia

Objective

- 19.160 The objective, to which component 4 of the subprogramme contributes, is to strengthen regional cooperation and integration for sustainable development, in line with the subregional priorities of South and South-West Asia, including sustainable connectivity, women's economic empowerment and the sustainable graduation of the least developed countries.

Strategy

- 19.161 To contribute to the objective, the component will:
- (a) Provide tailored analytical support, policy advice and technical assistance, and facilitate knowledge exchange and dialogues for member States and other stakeholders, on transboundary or common development priorities, in particular for least developed countries, landlocked developing countries and small island developing States, such as connectivity for economic corridors, disaster risk resilience, energy transition, women's economic empowerment and disability inclusion;
 - (b) Convene subregional consultations on sustainable development, including through the South and South-West Asia Network on the Sustainable Development Goals, to facilitate the sharing of good practices and the articulation of subregional perspectives that contribute to the relevant ESCAP knowledge products and forums, such as the Asia-Pacific Forum on Sustainable Development and the high-level political forum on sustainable development;
 - (c) Collaborate with subregional intergovernmental organizations for the coordination and mutual leveraging of subregional initiatives and facilitate ESCAP communication with the respective secretariats;
 - (d) Serve as the focal point for the Commission's engagement with the resident coordinator system and United Nations country teams, including through substantive assistance in preparing common country assessments and United Nations Sustainable Development Cooperation Frameworks, in particular with regard to the transboundary dimensions of sustainable development, and assist country-level programming by providing subregional perspectives and access to regional networks and facilitating South-South and triangular cooperation;
 - (e) Forge partnerships with other development partners, and private sector and civil society organizations in common areas of work, for enhanced impact in supporting member States towards their achievement of the Goals;
 - (f) Deepen linkages and synergies with other ESCAP subprogrammes and components in common areas of work, for enhanced harmonization and coherence in the delivery of assistance to member States.
- 19.162 The above-mentioned work will help member States to make progress towards achieving Goals 1, 5, 7 to 10, 12, 13 and 17.
- 19.163 The above-mentioned work is expected to result in:
- (a) Enhanced connectivity in the subregion, especially for people in least developed countries and landlocked developing countries;
 - (b) Strengthened capacity of member States in the subregion, especially least developed countries, landlocked developing countries and small island developing States, to mitigate and adapt to the impact of climate change and to reduce the risk of disasters, including those induced by climate change, in particular for people in vulnerable situations;

- (c) Enhanced design and implementation of policies and subregional cooperation among member States in the transition to sustainable energy accessible to people in remote areas and in marginalized situations in South and South-West Asia;
- (d) Enriched exchange of experiences and best practices between governments, civil society, academia/think tanks, the private sector, United Nations agencies, subregional organizations and other international organizations and financial institutions to bridge knowledge gaps for addressing the Goals.

Programme performance in 2025

Strengthened multi-stakeholder cooperation on water and climate change nexus in South Asia

- 19.164 The component has worked to explore the areas of knowledge exchange and cooperation on the water and climate change nexus, recognizing its critical importance for sustainable development in the subregion. To build momentum, the component organized an informal multi-stakeholder dialogue on the water and climate nexus in the context of the India Water Vision 2047. Furthermore, the component convened two virtual subregional multi-stakeholder reviews of Sustainable Development Goal 6 on clean water and sanitation as part of its annual South and South-West Asia subregional forum on sustainable development. These reviews provided a platform for Governments, experts and civil society to assess progress, share lessons and explore integrated approaches to address the challenges relating to the water and climate nexus. These collective efforts supported the activities relating to ESCAP resolution 81/3 on strengthening cooperation on the water and climate change nexus for sustainable development in Asia and the Pacific, reaffirming the regional commitment to integrated action and positioning the component as a key contributor to advancing water-climate cooperation for sustainable development.
- 19.165 Progress towards the objective is presented in the performance measure below (see table 19.43).

Table 19.43
Performance measure

2023 (actual)	2024 (actual)	2025 (actual)
—	Countries from the South Asia subregion exchanged country-level good practices and lesson on the water and climate change nexus	A multi-stakeholder Sustainable Development Goal 6 review and dialogue on the water and climate change nexus highlighted priorities for subregional cooperation

Planned results for 2027

Result 1: accelerated transition to sustainable energy

Programme performance in 2025 and target for 2027

- 19.166 The component's work contributed to two countries (Bangladesh and Pakistan) in the subregion presenting their draft action plans on the sustainable energy transition, which met the planned target.
- 19.167 Progress towards the objective and the target for 2027 are presented in the performance measure below (see table 19.44).

Table 19.44
Performance measure

2023 (actual)	2024 (actual)	2025 (actual)	2026 (planned)	2027 (planned)
The Lao People's Democratic Republic, Malaysia, Singapore and Thailand shared their experience on cross-border electricity trading with Bangladesh, Bhutan, India and Nepal	Bangladesh, Bhutan, India and Nepal identified priorities through a multi-country policy dialogue on regional energy connectivity	Two countries (Bangladesh and Pakistan) in the subregion drafted action plans on the sustainable energy transition	One subregional organization promotes cooperation in the sustainable energy transition	Two countries share their sustainable energy transition progress achievements with other South and South-West Asia member States

Result 2: bridging the digital gap to leave no one behind in South and South-West Asia

Programme performance in 2025 and target for 2027

- 19.168 The component's work contributed to stakeholders initiating a cross-country pilot project between India and Nepal on digital cooperation of customs at border areas to bridge the digital divide, which met the planned target.
- 19.169 Progress towards the objective and the target for 2027 are presented in the performance measure below (see table 19.45).

Table 19.45
Performance measure

2023 (actual)	2024 (actual)	2025 (actual)	2026 (planned)	2027 (planned)
2,032 women were trained on digital marketing and e-commerce	Stakeholders identified priority interventions to bridge the digital divide	Stakeholders initiate a cross-country pilot project between India and Nepal on digital cooperation of customs at border areas to bridge the digital divide	Stakeholders initiate an initiative on bridging the digital divide with a subregional organization	Stakeholders from two member States demonstrate that they have benefited from digital upskilling

Result 3: strengthening cross-border trade connectivity in South and South-West Asia, with a focus on women entrepreneurs and start-ups at the borders

Proposed programme plan for 2027

- 19.170 Cross-border trade in South and South-West Asia holds great potential to drive inclusive growth and strengthen regional integration. The subregion's economies are deeply interconnected, yet the movement of goods and services often faces challenges. The component has undertaken field-based assessments and stakeholder consultations to better understand local trade dynamics and identify capacity gaps and has implemented capacity-building programmes for women entrepreneurs from the border regions between India and Nepal.

Lessons learned and planned change

- 19.171 The lesson for the component was that, while efforts to strengthen cross-border trade connectivity have highlighted the importance of customs cooperation, more attention is needed to establish procedures and facilitation measures inclusive of women and small and medium-sized enterprises.

In applying the lesson, the component will bring the views of women and small and medium-sized enterprise leaders into customs cooperation efforts, assess the barriers and consult with border authorities, chambers of commerce and women's business associations. These dialogues will help to identify practical actions to improve connectivity and the flow of goods and services and reach consensus on priority steps forward.

19.172 Expected progress towards the objective is presented in the performance measure below (see table 19.46).

Table 19.46

Performance measure

2023 (actual)	2024 (actual)	2025 (actual)	2026 (planned)	2027 (planned)
—	—	Issues for cross-border trade connectivity for women and start-ups at the borders identified, with engagement from women traders and small and medium-sized enterprises	Road map for strengthening cross-border trade and removing barriers developed with the traders	Two countries create an enabling environment that promotes cross-border trade among women and small and medium-sized enterprises

Deliverables

19.173 Table 19.47 lists all deliverables of the component.

Table 19.47

Component 4: deliverables for the period 2025–2027, by category and subcategory

Category and subcategory	2025 planned	2025 actual	2026 planned	2027 planned
A. Facilitation of the intergovernmental process and expert bodies				
Parliamentary documentation (number of documents)	1	1	—	—
1. Report for the Commission	1	1	—	—
Substantive services for meetings (number of three-hour meetings)	4	8	4	4
2. Meetings of the South and South-West Asia Forum on the Sustainable Development Goals	4	8	4	4
B. Generation and transfer of knowledge				
Field and technical cooperation projects (number of projects)	—	1	—	1
3. On institutional programmatic priorities of ESCAP in South and South-West Asia	—	1	—	1
Seminars, workshops and training events (number of days)	2	3	2	2
4. On thematic areas related to sustainable development	2	3	2	2
Technical materials (number of materials)	5	6	—	2
5. Development paper series on economic and social development	5	6	—	2
C. Substantive deliverables				
Consultation, advice and advocacy: expert advice to member States of the subregion in implementing the 2030 Agenda and promoting regional economic cooperation and integration.				

Component 5

Subregional activities for development in South-East Asia

Objective

- 19.174 The objective, to which component 5 of the subprogramme contributes, is to strengthen regional cooperation and integration for sustainable development, in line with the subregional priorities of South-East Asia, including sustainable connectivity, inclusive and equitable societies, the efficient management of natural resources and resilient development.

Strategy

- 19.175 To contribute to the objective, the component will:
- (a) Lead the coordination of high-level policy dialogues and strategic working meetings to advance the implementation of the ASEAN and United Nations plan of action;
 - (b) Deepen strategic cooperation with ASEAN by intensifying engagement with the ASEAN secretariat and relevant sectoral bodies and committees. This includes joint initiatives aimed at achieving the Sustainable Development Goals and subregional priorities, including through support for the implementation of the ASEAN 2045 vision;
 - (c) Promote collaboration with subregional intergovernmental organizations and member States for an effective representation of subregional perspectives at regional and global consultations;
 - (d) Expand partnerships with civil society organizations to promote inclusive development and support persons in vulnerable situations. This includes fostering meaningful participation in the subregional Sustainable Development Goals forum and raising awareness of the Goals among young people through collaborative initiatives with the Association of Pacific Rim Universities in mutual areas of interest;
 - (e) Provide targeted implementation support to the Commission's subprogrammes relating to the subregion's priorities;
 - (f) Serve as the primary focal point for the Commission's engagement with the resident coordinator system and United Nations country teams, including through substantive assistance in preparing common country assessments and United Nations Sustainable Development Cooperation Frameworks, and facilitate country-level programming by integrating subregional perspectives, leveraging regional networks and promoting South-South and triangular cooperation;
 - (g) Support inter-agency coordination and multi-stakeholder partnerships focused on sustainable investment and finance, inclusive and equitable societies, Sustainable Development Goal progress monitoring and enhanced ASEAN engagement, while ensuring coherence and synergy across implementation processes and platforms;
 - (h) Support countries in special situations in the subregion in implementing their relevant programmes of action.
- 19.176 The above-mentioned work will help to support member States in their progress towards the achievement of Goals 3, 5, 9, 10, 13 and 17.
- 19.177 The above-mentioned work is expected to result in:
- (a) An enhanced policy environment to support inclusive business and investment for sustainable development in the subregion;
 - (b) Fairer and more equitable access to social protection, especially for those most vulnerable, such as women, youth, older persons and persons with disabilities, and strengthened disability statistics, ageing and disability policies and social protection floor costing;

- (c) Improved coordination and coherence of technical assistance provided under the ASEAN 2045 vision in the subregion.

Programme performance in 2025

Integrated multi-stakeholder engagement for sustainable development in South-East Asia

- 19.178 The ASEAN Multi-Stakeholder Forum on Sustainability was established in 2025 to integrate several key platforms aimed at advancing the Sustainable Development Goals in South-East Asia. These included the High-Level Brainstorming Dialogue, the ASEAN Forum on Sustainable Development Goals with national development planning agencies, and the South-East Asia Multi-Stakeholder Forum on Sustainable Development Goals implementation. The component has consolidated these initiatives to streamline efforts, optimize resource use and enhance audience engagement. A major milestone of this integrated approach was the inclusion, for the first time, of participants from ASEAN sectoral bodies, including senior officials from the political and sociocultural communities, as well as national development planning agencies. Notably, the Forum strengthened engagement between government officials and a broader range of stakeholders, including civil society organizations, the private sector, academia and youth groups, which are not typically involved in formal ASEAN processes. This marked a significant step towards more inclusive, coordinated and participatory regional dialogue on sustainable development.
- 19.179 Progress towards the objective is presented in the performance measure below (see table 19.48).

Table 19.48
Performance measure

2023 (actual)	2024 (actual)	2025 (actual)
—	Three separate subregional platforms on the implementation of the Sustainable Development Goals in South-East Asia	Inaugural ASEAN Multi-Stakeholder Forum on Sustainability, enabling more inclusive, coordinated and participatory regional dialogue on sustainable development

Planned results for 2027

Result 1: aligned investment policies and regulations for the achievement of the Sustainable Development Goals

Programme performance in 2025 and target for 2027

- 19.180 The component's efforts supported Cambodia, Indonesia, Thailand and Viet Nam in adopting national policies aligned with the ASEAN Regional Investment Promotion Action Plan 2025–2030, which met the planned target.
- 19.181 Progress towards the objective and the target for 2027 are presented in the performance measure below (see table 19.49).

Table 19.49
Performance measure

2023 (actual)	2024 (actual)	2025 (actual)	2026 (planned)	2027 (planned)
Member States agreed to develop a subregional action plan on sustainable investment to accelerate the implementation of the Sustainable Development Goals	Member States adopted the ASEAN Regional Investment Promotion Action Plan 2025–2030	Cambodia, Indonesia, Thailand and Viet Nam adopted policies aligned with the investment priorities of the subregional action plan on sustainable investment	Member States develop the next phase of the ASEAN Regional Investment Promotion Action Plan by focusing on additional sectors	Member States implement coordinated regional initiatives aligned with the ASEAN Regional Investment Promotion Action Plan

Result 2: youth engagement towards achieving the Sustainable Development Goals

Programme performance in 2025 and target for 2027

- 19.182 The component's work contributed to 45 students participating online (30) and in-person (15) in the ASEAN Multi-Stakeholder Forum on Sustainability, with 7 students giving interventions on voluntary national reviews, clean water and sanitation, financing clean energy transition, and the care economy, which did not meet the planned target of students taking part in the conceptualization of a session at the subregional forum for sustainable development. The target was not met due to modifications in the format of the forum undertaken in response to liquidity constraints.
- 19.183 Progress towards the objective and the target for 2027 are presented in the performance measure below (see table 19.50).

Table 19.50
Performance measure

2023 (actual)	2024 (actual)	2025 (actual)	2026 (planned)	2027 (planned)
10 students intervened at the subregional forum for sustainable development	20 students made statements and contributed substantively to the discussions at the subregional forum for sustainable development	45 students participated in the ASEAN Multi-Stakeholder Forum on Sustainability, with 15 students joining the Forum in person. Seven students provided interventions	Increased number of universities participating in activities to increase awareness about the Sustainable Development Goals among their students	Students co-create an associated event to the ASEAN Multi-Stakeholder Forum on Sustainability

Result 3: enhanced regional dialogue and cooperation on digital transformation for sustainable development

Proposed programme plan for 2027

- 19.184 Digital transformation is a growing priority across South-East Asia. As digitalization reshapes economies and public services, it brings both opportunities and challenges that require coordinated, cross-sectoral responses. The component has taken steps to foster collaboration by convening government officials from various agencies alongside stakeholders from civil society, the private sector, academia and youth groups.

Lessons learned and planned change

19.185 The lesson for the component was that a whole-of-government approach was essential to strengthen subregional collaboration further and ensure inclusive, effective and sustainable digital development aligned with national and regional goals. In applying the lesson, the component plans to support dedicated ASEAN working groups on digital cooperation, facilitating joint capacity-building programmes for government agencies beyond ICT ministries, thereby promoting knowledge-sharing on best practices and scalable innovations. The component also aims to support the development of policy frameworks that align digital transformation with broader economic and sustainable development goals, ensuring that digitalization serves as a catalyst for inclusive growth across South-East Asia.

19.186 Expected progress towards the objective is presented in the performance measure below (see table 19.51).

Table 19.51

Performance measure

2023 (actual)	2024 (actual)	2025 (actual)	2026 (planned)	2027 (planned)
–	–	Member States discussed digitalization opportunities and challenges at the subregional level through the ASEAN Multi-Stakeholder Forum on Sustainability and the round table on ASEAN-Eurasian Economic Union digital cooperation	Member States identify digital transformation areas for development and cooperation	Member States launch joint digital transformation initiative

Deliverables

19.187 Table 19.52 lists all deliverables of the component.

Table 19.52

Component 5: deliverables for the period 2025–2027, by category and subcategory

Category and subcategory	2025 planned	2025 actual	2026 planned	2027 planned
A. Facilitation of the intergovernmental process and expert bodies				
Parliamentary documentation (number of documents)	1	1	–	–
1. Report for the Commission	1	1	–	–
Substantive services for meetings (number of three-hour meetings)	9	8	8	8
Meetings of:				
2. Expert groups on policy and programme options to address emerging sustainable development issues in South-East Asia	2	1	–	–
3. The South-East Asia Multi-stakeholder Forum on the Implementation of the Sustainable Development Goals	4	3	4	–

<i>Category and subcategory</i>	<i>2025 planned</i>	<i>2025 actual</i>	<i>2026 planned</i>	<i>2027 planned</i>
4. ASEAN member States, the ASEAN secretariat and the ASEAN sectoral working groups on sustainable development in South-East Asia	3	4	—	—
5. The High-level Brainstorming Dialogue on Enhancing Complementarities between the ASEAN Community Vision 2025 and the 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development	—	—	4	—
6. ASEAN Sustainability Week	—	—	—	8
B. Generation and transfer of knowledge				
Field and technical cooperation projects (number of projects)	1	1	—	—
7. On institutional programmatic priorities of ESCAP in South-East Asia	1	1	—	—
Seminars, workshops and training events (number of days)	—	6	14	17
8. On the implementation of the Plan of Action to Implement the Joint Declaration on Comprehensive Partnership between the Association of Southeast Asian Nations and the United Nations	—	—	3	1
9. On sustainable investment	—	2	4	8
10. On the monitoring of progress towards the Sustainable Development Goals	—	2	2	1
11. For youth on the Sustainable Development Goals	—	—	3	4
12. On rail interoperability	—	—	—	1
13. On renewable energy and the implementation of related frameworks	—	—	—	1
14. On digitalization	—	2	2	1
Technical materials (number of materials)	1	1	—	—
15. On the implementation of the Plan of Action to Implement the Joint Declaration on Comprehensive Partnership between the Association of Southeast Asian Nations and the United Nations (2021–2025)	1	1	—	—
C. Substantive deliverables				
Consultation, advice and advocacy: consultations and advisory support to the subregional member States on sustainable investment and finance, inclusive and equitable societies and monitoring of progress towards the Sustainable Development Goals; consultations on enhanced engagement with ASEAN; side events at the Asia-Pacific Forum on Sustainable Development.				

Subprogramme 9

Energy

Objective

- 19.188 The objective, to which this subprogramme contributes, is to ensure access to affordable, reliable, sustainable and modern energy for all in Asia and the Pacific by enhancing member States' capacity for energy access, renewable energy, energy efficiency and energy connectivity.

Strategy

- 19.189 To contribute to the objective, the subprogramme will enhance the evidence base for the achievement of Sustainable Development Goal 7 and Goals with interlinkages to it, and support member States in progressing towards Goals 7, 13 and 17. Specifically, the subprogramme will:
- (a) Facilitate intergovernmental dialogue and develop and disseminate evidence-based policy recommendations and guidance related to improving energy efficiency and expanding access to modern energy, growing the share of renewable sources of energy in the energy mix, adopting energy-efficient technologies and approaches, and increasing energy connectivity;
 - (b) Provide capacity-building activities focused on facilitating planning and policy development for achieving Goal 7, including in least developed countries, based on local contexts and in

alignment with national priorities, in cooperation with resident coordinator offices to leverage institutional resources and ensure the efficiency of work programme implementation;

- (c) Produce and contribute to the development of knowledge products focused on broadening understanding of the benefits and implications of energy connectivity for energy security and resilience, affordability and sustainability;
- (d) Provide access to up-to-date data, policy information and energy infrastructure maps through the Asia-Pacific Energy Portal and other knowledge platforms;
- (e) Review regional and national progress against the targets of Goal 7 and provide support through the development and implementation of road maps and plans (Goal 7 road maps, the regional road map on power system connectivity and national cooling action plans), as applicable, and by promoting the use of modelling and policy planning tools and methodologies;
- (f) Focus capacity-building efforts on the acceleration of progress towards Goal 7 targets and emissions reductions, in particular energy efficiency, access to clean cooking fuels and technologies; sustainable cooling; the sustainability of supply chains for minerals, materials and technologies critical for energy transition; cleaner use of fossil fuels; and energy connectivity, with a special emphasis on countries in special situations;
- (g) Mainstream a gender perspective by facilitating dialogue and producing knowledge products that include the energy system's impacts on women and highlight their contribution to a sustainable energy transition, working jointly with subprogramme 6.

19.190 The above-mentioned work is expected to result in:

- (a) The adoption of evidence-based policies, strategies and plans to increase energy access, energy efficiency and the use of cleaner sources of energy and enabling technologies at the national and subnational levels;
- (b) Improved capacity to implement policies for the transition to renewable sources of energy, environmentally sound energy technologies and net-zero emissions goals, targets and ambitions;
- (c) Increased capacity of policymakers and regulators to plan and implement power system connectivity initiatives that enable the scaling up of renewable energies;
- (d) Greater recognition among policymakers of a gender perspective in the sustainable energy transition, including the potential for women to accelerate progress.

Programme performance in 2025

Enhanced policies related to sustainable energy transition

19.191 A sustainable energy transition is essential for achieving inclusive economic growth, enhancing energy security and addressing the escalating impacts of climate change. The subprogramme provided technical assistance, organized policy dialogues and applied standardized methodologies to support member States, especially countries in special situations, to advance policy measures on energy access, renewable energy and energy efficiency through Sustainable Development Goal 7 road maps, national cooling action plans and nationally determined contribution development support. The provision by ESCAP of tailored policy recommendations, tools and modelling approaches helped build government capacity in Cambodia, Fiji, Micronesia (Federated States of), Tonga and Viet Nam to design and operationalize measures that support national priorities and embed Sustainable Development Goal 7, climate goals and energy transition objectives within national development agendas.

19.192 Progress towards the objective is presented in the performance measure below (see table 19.53).

Table 19.53
Performance measure

2023 (actual)	2024 (actual)	2025 (actual)
–	Cambodia released an updated climate strategy incorporating sustainable cooling recommendations from the 2022 national cooling action plan Tonga released an updated energy strategy incorporating recommendations from the 2021 Sustainable Development Goal 7 road map Fiji released an updated national energy policy incorporating recommendations from the 2023 Sustainable Development Goal 7 road map Viet Nam introduced sustainable cooling into a decision incorporating recommendations aligned with the national cooling action plans development process	The Federated States of Micronesia released an updated national energy policy incorporating priorities identified under the 2025 Sustainable Development Goal 7 road map Cambodia submitted its third-generation nationally determined contribution, with numerous measures related to sustainable cooling

Planned results for 2027

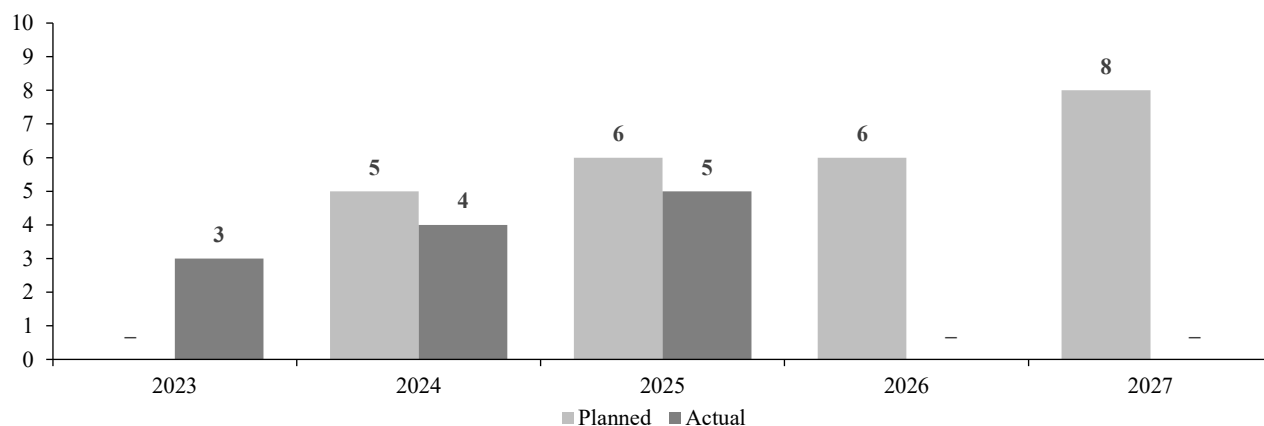
Result 1: countries adopt national cooling action plans

Programme performance in 2025 and target for 2027

- 19.193 The subprogramme's work contributed to one additional national cooling action plan issued by Viet Nam in 2025, for a total of five national cooling action plans issued by member States, which did not meet the planned target of six national action cooling plans. The target was not met as timelines for the approval and launch of national cooling action plans in member States were extended beyond the original expected timeline.
- 19.194 Progress towards the objective and the target for 2027 are presented in the performance measure below (see figure 19.X).

Figure 19.X

Performance measure: number of national cooling action plans issued by member States (cumulative)



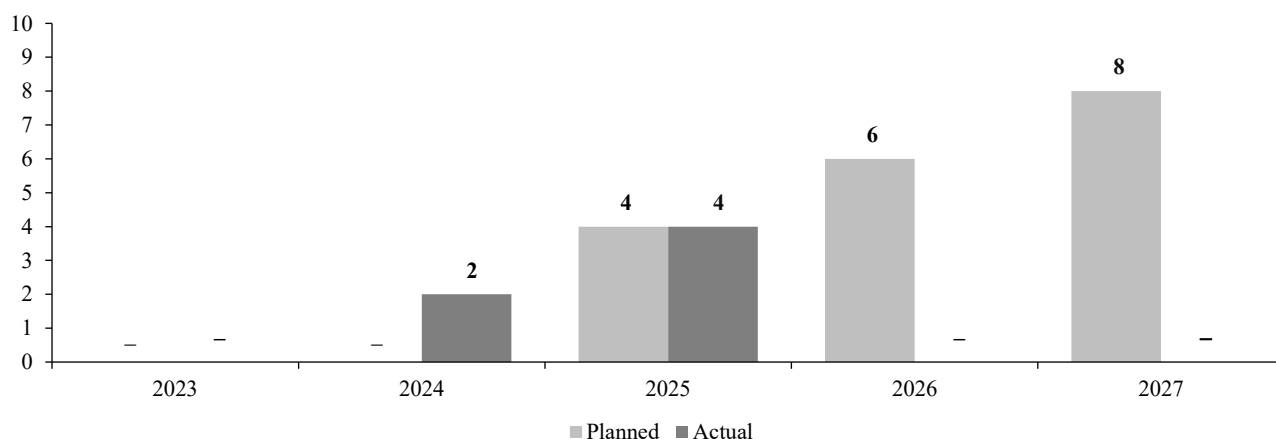
Result 2: increased cooperation of member States in the Asia-Pacific region on cross-border power connectivity projects

Programme performance in 2025 and target for 2027

- 19.195 The subprogramme's work contributed to four newly announced bilateral and multilateral power connectivity projects and initiatives, which met the planned target.
- 19.196 Progress towards the objective and the target for 2027 are presented in the performance measure below (see figure 19.XI).

Figure 19.XI

Performance measure: number of newly announced bilateral and multilateral power connectivity projects and initiatives (cumulative)



Result 3: new intergovernmentally agreed milestones to advance regional power system connectivity

Proposed programme plan for 2027

- 19.197 The Regional Road Map on Power System Connectivity and its associated time-bound milestones have provided a common and agreed framework to translate political commitment for regional cooperation on power system connectivity into action. As many of the milestones concluded in 2025, member States decided to develop a new set of milestones for the period up to 2035.

Lessons learned and planned change

- 19.198 The lesson for the subprogramme was that milestones that are concrete, time-bound and linked to clear actions by member States lead to stronger ownership and more measurable results. In applying this lesson, the subprogramme will support the development of new milestones of the Regional Road Map using the meetings of the Expert Working Group on Energy Connectivity as the primary platform for consultation and consensus-building among member States, so that new milestones for the next phase of regional action on power system connectivity will be presented for endorsement at the Fourth Asian and Pacific Energy Forum, in 2027.
- 19.199 Expected progress towards the objective is presented in the performance measure below (see table 19.54).

Table 19.54
Performance measure

2023 (actual)	2024 (actual)	2025 (actual)	2026 (planned)	2027 (planned)
Member States reaffirmed the importance of energy connectivity at the Asian and Pacific Energy Forum	Member States made progress towards achieving the milestones of the Regional Road Map on Power System Connectivity	The Committee on Energy formally reviewed the implementation of the Road Map The 15th Expert Group Meeting on energy connectivity called for the development of the “next set of milestones”	Member States develop new milestones for the Regional Road Map	Member States consider the endorsement of the new milestones for the Regional Road Map

Deliverables

19.200 Table 19.55 lists all deliverables of the subprogramme.

Table 19.55
Subprogramme 9: deliverables for the period 2025–2027, by category and subcategory

Category and subcategory	2025 planned	2025 actual	2026 planned	2027 planned
A. Facilitation of the intergovernmental process and expert bodies				
Parliamentary documentation (number of documents)	2	2	1	4
Reports for:				
1. The Commission	1	1	1	1
2. The Committee on Energy	1	1	–	–
3. The Asian and Pacific Energy Forum	–	–	–	3
Substantive services for meetings (number of three-hour meetings)	16	12	10	15
Meetings of:				
4. The Committee on Energy	6	5	–	–
5. The Asian and Pacific Energy Forum	–	–	–	5
6. The Expert Working Group on Universal Access to Modern Energy Services, Renewable Energy, Energy Efficiency and Cleaner Use of Fossil Fuels	4	3	4	4
7. The Expert Working Group on Energy Connectivity	4	4	4	4
8. The United Nations Special Programme for the Economies of Central Asia Working Group on Water, Energy and Environment (energy-related issues)	2	–	2	2
B. Generation and transfer of knowledge				
Field and technical cooperation projects (number of projects)	2	18	2	2
9. On the implementation of Goal 7	2	18	2	2
Seminars, workshops and training events (number of days)	1	1	1	1
10. Policy dialogues on energy	1	1	1	1
Publications (number of publications)	2	2	2	2
11. On ensuring access to affordable, reliable, sustainable and modern energy for all	2	2	2	2

Section 19 Economic and social development in Asia and the Pacific

<i>Category and subcategory</i>	<i>2025 planned</i>	<i>2025 actual</i>	<i>2026 planned</i>	<i>2027 planned</i>
Technical materials (number of materials)	5	5	4	4
12. On ensuring access to affordable, reliable, sustainable and modern energy for all	5	5	—	—
13. Working papers on ensuring access to affordable, reliable, sustainable and modern energy for all	—	—	2	2
14. Policy briefs on ensuring access to affordable, reliable, sustainable and modern energy for all	—	—	2	2
C. Substantive deliverables				
Consultation, advice and advocacy: policy advice to all member States, upon request, on the implementation of Goal 7 and energy connectivity; side events on energy at the Asia-Pacific Forum on Sustainable Development.				
Databases and substantive digital materials: Asia-Pacific Energy Portal (containing more than 200 data sets, 3,000 policy documents and a mapping of more than 6,000 power plants).				
D. Communication deliverables				
Outreach programmes, special events and information materials: information materials on sustainable energy, primarily for government officials and technical experts in the region; International Day of Clean Energy.				